

# **TITLE: AISHA AND THE SANDS OF DESTINY.**

## **ACT 1. THE GILDED CAGE**

EXT. DESERT – DAWN

The sun does not rise over the Kingdom of QAZAR AL-ZAMAN.  
It ignites it.

A golden flare spills over endless dunes, racing toward a massive ring-wall of limestone that encircles the kingdom like a sacred embrace.  
The morning heat touches the magical barrier atop the walls — a faint shimmer, like trembling glass — before it fades into perfect transparency.

Caravans approach the open gates: merchants on camels, travelers on foot, men and women carrying crates of spices, woven carpets, vials of curious herbs, preserved insects floating in liquid, and shimmering fabrics from distant coasts.

Their chatter fills the air — excitement, exhaustion, bragging, bargaining.

EXT. CITY GATE – CONTINUOUS

A grand wooden counter sits just inside the gate, covered with scrolls, wax seals, and ink pots.  
Behind it sits the ENTRY CLERK — a middle-aged bureaucrat whose face says he's seen everything and enjoys stamping things a little too much.

MERCHANT #1

(placing a basket forward)

“Saffron, cinnamon, crushed star-pepper... finest from the East!”

The Clerk sniffs a fingerful of spice — immediately COUGHS explosively.

CLERK:

“Approved.”

STAMP.

Merchant beams and rushes past.

MERCHANT #2

(holding a jar of glowing beetles):

“These, sir, are bioluminescent — ”

CLERK:

(recoiling)

“No sorcery, no bugs, no night-crawling mysteries. Denied.”

STAMP — REJECTED.

The merchant gasps, deeply offended.

EXT. CITY GATE – SKY ABOVE

Suddenly —

SCREEEEEE!!

A streak cuts through the sky — ALTAIR, the Royal Hawk, feathers sleek, eyes sharp, carrying a sealed scroll with red wax.

He dives toward the palace.

ALTAIR:

“Make way! Royal Air Mail! Important! Urgent! Out of the way!”

Below, merchants shield their heads. The Clerk rolls his eyes.

EXT. INNER GATE – CONTINUOUS

Guards suddenly close the heavy golden doors.

Merchants outside yell in panic as the doors slam just before they enter.

Dust rises. Altair swoops over the city.

EXT. QAZAR AL-ZAMAN – FLYOVER

Altair flies across the vibrant kingdom:

- narrow and wide streets lined with mosaics
- colorful markets with silks and fruits
- artisans hammering brass

- children running beneath hanging lanterns
- turquoise domes and cascading gardens
- an enormous central plaza with a mandala-like mosaic

Rising over all of this is the GREAT PALACE QAZAR AL-ZAMAN, crowned with turquoise domes, surrounded by lush courtyards and fountains. Altair banks toward the tallest tower.

#### INT. PALACE – AISHA’S BALCONY – MORNING

AISHA (16) stands on her vast balcony overlooking the internal courtyard. Her kaftan and headscarf dance in the light breeze. Beside her lounges DORA the PANTHER — short white with black spots fur, golden collar with sun amulet, royal lazy attitude. Aisha leans forward, eyes sparkling with longing.

AISHA:

“Look at them, Dora... today the traders bring wonders from the Edge Lands. Indigo, star-fruit, shells that glow in moonlight... and I cannot even see them up close.”

Dora stretches luxuriously on her royal pink silk cushion.

DORA:

“Aisha, Aisha... why chase the world when you can be lazy like me? Eat grapes, nap in sunbeams, let politics wait another ten years.”

Aisha shoots her a look.

AISHA:

“How am I meant to rule one day if I’m not allowed beyond these walls?”

DORA:

“Because, my dear princess... you are still a child.”

Aisha stiffens.

AISHA:

(quiet, firm, frowning hilariously)

“I’m not.”

A moment of silence.

Then—

SCREEEEEEEE!

Altair zooms past the balcony, feathers wild, expression frantic.

AISHA: “Altair?”

He freezes mid-air for half a second, wings flapping awkwardly.

ALTAIR:

“Royal business! Urgent! Sorry, Princess!”

(he darts away)

Aisha and Dora exchange a stunned look.

DORA:

“You see? Complicated royal things. Better left alone.”

Aisha’s eyes narrow with a spark of rebellion.

AISHA (whispering to herself, mischievous):

“...Well, opportunity does knock. Or scream.”

She takes off running.

DORA:

“AISHA—! Get back here!”

INT. ROYAL MESSENGER HALL – MOMENTS LATER

A majestic room:

arabesque arches, scroll shelves, painted tapestries depicting ancient history, a door open to a serene internal patio.

Altair is perched on a golden Royal Falconer’s Perch, trying to smooth his feathers after his chaotic flight.

Aisha bursts in, slightly breathless.

Altair straightens instantly, puffing himself up as if he hadn’t just nearly collided with three domes and a laundry line.

AISHA:

“Altair! You came so fast today.”

ALTAIR:

“I bring serious news from the Borderlands. This scroll must reach the Sultan immediately—sealed, unread, untouched.”

Aisha gasps dramatically.

AISHA:

“Oh! But—Altair, didn’t anyone tell you? My father... he woke with a terrible fever.”

Altair’s eyes widen.

ALTAIR:

“The Sultan? A fever? Impossible. He—he never gets sick! —”

AISHA:

“It came suddenly. He asked me to collect all morning dispatches personally.. He could not even stand.”

Altair flutters in distress.

ALTAIR:

“Oh dear skies... I should bring him water... or soup—”

AISHA:

“No, no. He asked me to take everything. I’ll deliver it myself”

Altair hesitates, torn.

She adds a soft, sad touch.

AISHA (super innocent eyes, pleading expression):

“He trusts you, Altair. Don’t make him walk. Pleeese”

ALTAIR:

“Fine... but don’t break the seal! Delivery confirmed!”

He drops the scroll into her hands.

Aisha beams.

INT. AISHA'S ROOM – SHORTLY AFTER

Aisha unrolls the scroll across her carpet.

Her expression shifts.

The map shows:

- Qazar al-Zaman untouched, glowing gold
- Neighboring kingdoms swallowed by dark ink clouds
- Names: Mayala, Ramlat al-Jawhar — crossed, scarred
- Notes scrawled urgently

“Shadows consume Mayala.”

“Ramlat al-Jawhar reduced to rocks.”

“Borders collapsing.”

“Royal armies required—urgent.”

“—Vizier of Outer Lands, Al-Raki Ibn Sharif”

Her breath tightens.

AISHA:

“...What happened out there?”

Suddenly—

KNOCK.

Too late to hide the broken seal.

The SULTAN enters.

Tall, old, tired eyes — a man who has carried too much loss.

SULTAN

“Aisha.”

Aisha freezes.

SULTAN:

(extends hand)

“Give me the scroll.”

She attempts a desperate smile.

AISHA:

“Oh! I was just taking it to you—”

SULTAN (firm):

“Now.”

She hands it over. The seal is broken.

His disappointment is heavier than anger.

SULTAN:

“You disobeyed. Again.

AISHA:

“I just looked! Because no one tells me anything! I’m nearly grown, Father, and you still—”

SULTAN (raising his voice for the first time):

“You do not decide what you are ready for!”

Aisha flinches. Dora lowers her head behind her.

SULTAN (quiet, but sharper):

“These matters are not gossip or curiosity. They are dangerous...far *too* dangerous for a child like you!”

AISHA (voice trembling with frustration):

“I am not a child!”

A long beat.

The Sultan gestures toward the towering walls beyond her balcony.

SULTAN:

“You think these walls will always protect you?

You think / will always be able to protect you?”

SULTAN (CONT'D)

(sad, bitter)

“Even / can fail!...”

Aisha stares — shaken.

AISHA:

“...What do you mean?”

He exhales, grief and fear flickering.

SULTAN:

“Your mother . She was just like you .. and I couldn’t save her.”  
Aisha freezes.

AISHA:

“You said she died of illness.”

SULTAN (steps back):

“And that is all you will know. For your own safety.”  
He turns to leave — but pauses to scold Dora.

SULTAN:

“And you... panther of the royal line... your duty is to guard her, not entertain her mischief. I expect your eyes on her at all times.”

Dora shrinks.

SULTAN (over his shoulder):

“Aisha... one step outside your bounds today, and I will lock your chambers. Do not test me.”  
He storms out.

INT. AISHA’S ROOM – MOMENTS LATER

DORA slumps dramatically onto the cushioned bench.

DORA

“Well. That went well.”

Aisha paces, fire in her chest.

AISHA:

“He lied to me. About everything. And if something threatens the kingdom, I won’t sit and smile like a painted doll.”

She steps onto the balcony.

Below, the palace service courtyard bustles.

A woman carries a tray of fresh pistachio honey buns.



Dora sniffs. Pupils dilate.

AISHA (sly grin):

“...You smell that, Dora?”

DORA (defensive):

“No. Absolutely not. Don’t even—”

AISHA:

“One bun for you... one bun for me...”

Dora collapses instantly.

DORA:

“...I hate how well you know me.”

EXT. PALACE COURTYARD – MOMENTS LATER

Dora approaches the bun seller with predatory grace.

BUN SELLER (shrieks):

“AIIIIII! THE SULTAN’S MONSTER IS AFTER MY TRAY!”

She flails dramatically.

A guard tries to intervene, slipping on honey glaze and knocking into another guard.

Buns fly like confetti.

One bun lands perfectly on a guard’s helmet.

Another sticks to Dora’s whiskers.

Dora delicately plucks one bun, sits proudly like a queen posing for a royal portrait.

BUN SELLER:

“GUARDS! SHE IS DEVOURING MY LIVELIHOOD!”

Guards scramble, slipping again, one holding the tray above his head defensively.

Dora chews with triumphant face and a big funny smile.

EXT. PALACE COURTYARD – AT THE SAME TIME

Aisha appears behind a SCARF SELLER carrying unsold scarves. The SCARF SELLER looks defeated after a bad sales day.

AISHA (soft, warm):

“These are lovely. May I try one?”

The woman freezes — she wasn’t prepared to speak to royalty.

SCARF SELLER:

“P-Princess... these are very simple scarves... not fitting for royalty ..—”

Aisha drapes the sand-colored scarf around her head dramatically, then turns with a full regal pose, as if waiting for approval.

AISHA (smiling brightly):

“Not fitting? Look at me. I’m magnificent.”

The seller blinks twice, utterly confused but unable to argue.

SCARF SELLER

“Yes... yes, Princess. Very magnificent.”

Aisha leans closer, lowering her voice in a conspiratorial whisper.

AISHA:

“I’ll take them. All of them. And as a royal favor, I’ll even help you carry them out. It must have been a long morning.”

The woman’s jaw drops. She squeaks instead of speaking.

Aisha picks up the basket like she’s done this her whole life, watches the chaotic bun scene, calculates the timing of the guards’ distraction.

They walk toward the service gate.

The guards — busy arguing with the bun seller — wave them through without looking.

Dora gasps from afar.

DORA:

“AISHA—?! NOOO—!”

But she is already gone.

Aisha steps into the bright marketplace — her first taste of the outside world.

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FADE OUT.  
END OF ACT 1.

## **ACT 2**

### **THE MARKET OF A THOUSAND WONDERS**

EXT. OUTER PALACE GATE — AFTERNOON

Aisha steps out of the palace walls disguised in a simple sand-colored servant's shawl.

The sun hangs high. Heat ripples across stone.

She breathes in —  
a mix of fear, awe... and freedom.

EXT. QAZAR AL-ZAMAN SOUK — ESTABLISHING SHOT —  
CONTINUOUS

The market explodes before her:

- Golden beams piercing through wooden slats
- Incense smoke rising like silver ribbons
- Vendors shouting, bargaining, laughing
- Children weaving between carpets in jeweled reds and deep indigos
- Copper lanterns clinking
- Heaps of pomegranates, figs, sea lilies, star-fruit

A world alive — loud, fragrant, chaotic.

Aisha steps into it like someone walking into sunlight for the first time.

She brushes her fingers along a fluttering ribbon of crimson silk.

AISHA (whisper, breathless):

“It’s like stepping into another world...”

She nearly trips over a basket of pomegranates.

DORA ENTERS — CHAOTIC ENERGY

A distant whisper-shout:

DORA (O.S.):

“AISHA!! AISHA!! AISHA!!”

Aisha jumps.

Dora bounds toward her, tail puffed like a startled cat.

DORA:

“I turned around for SIX SECONDS and my princess became a fugitive!”

AISHA:

“Dora, please—”

DORA:

“He’ll turn me into a carpet! A white carpet, Aisha!  
I shed too much for that! It’s undignified!”

Aisha grabs her face, hugs her tightly.

AISHA:

“Just stay with me. Just this once.”

Dora melts, sighing.

DORA (grumbling):

“...I hate that I love you.”

They walk deeper into the souk.

SONG SEQUENCE: “A THOUSANDS WONDERS”

Music rises — warm oud strings, gentle qanun, rhythmic darbuka.

Market crowds swirl into motion as Aisha and Dora step forward.

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VERSE 1 — Aisha

AISHA:

Every color, every sound,  
Like a story spun around—  
Worlds I’ve only dreamed about,  
Now bloom before my eyes.

Spices rise into the air,  
Silks like sunsets everywhere,  
I could wander, I could dare,  
Beneath a thousand skies...

Aisha lifts a lantern, its jeweled facets casting constellations on her cheeks.

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VERSE 2 — Dora

DORA:

I smell almonds, roasted sweet,  
Pistachios beneath my feet—  
This whole place is one big treat,  
A feast for royal paws.

Velvet cushions, all hand-made,  
Silks that never crease or fade—  
Why chase trouble? I'd prefer,  
A life of snacks and perfect fur.

She belly-flops onto a velvet cushion, kneading it happily.

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PRE-CHORUS — Aisha

Aisha tastes pomegranate seeds, eyes sparkling.

AISHA:

If this is freedom's gentle taste,  
If wonder waits beyond our gate,  
Then how can I just stand and wait...  
for life to pass me by?

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CHORUS — Aisha & Dora (dancing in the market)

BOTH:

Wide as the sky, my heart learns to fly,  
Bright as the dawn where the new roads lie—  
Maybe the world has been waiting for me,  
A thousand wonders together to see.

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VERSE 3 — Alternating

AISHA:

Lantern lights like fallen stars—

DORA:

And grilled cheese wrapped in golden jars—

AISHA (laughing):

Every path leads someplace far—

DORA:

Preferably with snacks.

AISHA:

Maybe I was meant to roam—

DORA:

“Or maybe you should turn back home—”

AISHA:

But something in my heart has grown—

DORA (softening):

And I can’t hold you back...

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## FINAL CHORUS

Wide as the sky, my heart learns to fly,  
Bright as the dawn where the new roads lie—  
Maybe the world has been waiting for me,  
A thousand wonders together to see.

The music fades as the sun glows warm across Aisha’s face.

## EXT. SOUK — POST-SONG BEAT

The market returns to its normal soundscape.

Aisha wanders toward a stall of trinkets, glowing quietly from within.

Aisha pauses near a dusty wooden post.  
A small golden cage hangs there.

Inside, a tiny white desert snake trembles under a piece of cloth.

The label reads:  
“Reptile Stock – For Broth & Tonic.”

Aisha kneels.

AISHA:

“...Oh. Little one...”

The snake lifts its head weakly, voice fragile:

SNAKE (trembling):

“...I don’t want to disappear in a pot.  
I haven’t even seen the moon yet...”

Aisha’s breath breaks.

AISHA:

“You... you can talk?”

SNAKE (quiet, quivering):

“I-I wasn’t born for stew... I promise I wasn’t.  
I’m small, but I can be helpful. I can warn you of sandstorms.  
I can smell danger before it comes...”

AISHA (gentle, touched):

“If I open the cage...can you be really fast?  
Before anyone sees you?”

The little snake musters a tiny bit of courage, lifting its head:

SNAKE (hopeful, tiny whisper):

“Please... let me stay with you.  
I’ll coil small. I don’t eat much.  
I’ll be quiet.  
I— I can be loyal.”

Without hesitation, Aisha unlatches the cage.

The snake slips into her palm, cold and feather-soft, then curls beneath her shawl around her neck.



Dora returns, licking crumbs of pistachio dust off her whiskers.

DORA:

“The pistachios were acceptable.  
The vendor was not.”

She squints suspiciously at Aisha.

DORA:

“...Why is your scarf... moving?”

Aisha freezes for half a second, then answers with perfect princess improvisation:

AISHA (innocent):

“Oh! Heat. Very... windy scarf.”

She pats the shawl firmly as the snake hides deeper.

DORA (narrowing eyes):

“...Mm-hm.”

They continue walking.

EXT. THE FAR EDGE OF THE MARKET — SUNSET

The colors thin.  
Noise fades.

A ragged stall stands quiet, displaying:

- meteor fragments
- worn desert compasses
- sand-scoured manuscripts
- broken celestial tiles

A BEDOUIN in indigo robes sits cross-legged, amber eyes glinting.

Aisha approaches, drawn to him.

AISHA:

“These aren’t from our kingdom...”

His voice is deep, ancient.

BEDOUIN:

“Neither are you, Child of High Walls.”

Aisha tenses.

AISHA:

“You’ve traveled. You’ve seen the lands beyond?”

BEDOUIN:

“I have crossed deserts older than empires.  
I have watched cities fall to shadow.  
I have walked roads your maps have forgotten.”

Dora squints.

DORA (whisper):

“He looks like a wrapped date pastry...”

Aisha elbows her.

The Bedouin reaches into his satchel and lifts a golden ring with a round moonstone at its center.

It glows faintly under the last sunbeam.

BEDOUIN:

“You seek answers.  
I cannot give you time...  
...but I can give you a key.”

He places the ring into her palm.

BEDOUIN:

“Light awakens it.  
You will understand when your path demands it.”

Aisha looks down at the ring.

Looks up—

He is gone.

Not vanished — simply gone, lost into the flowing river of market people.

Dora looks up, sniffing the ring suspiciously.

DORA:

“Oh wonderful.  
We’ve been here one afternoon and you’re already collecting shiny cursed  
souvenirs.”

Aisha smiles faintly.

AISHA:

“Maybe it’s lucky.”

EXT. CITY STREETS — SUNSET

The sky burns orange. The souk glows with lanterns.  
Aisha and Dora walk side-by-side through the crowd — unaware of how  
everything has just changed.

Aisha touches the hidden snake beneath her shawl. Then she touches the ring.

END OF ACT 2

**ACT 3.**  
**ONE WISH**

INT. AISHA'S CHAMBERS – NIGHT

Moonlight spills across the marble and rose-quartz floor. The chamber is a treasure-box of warm lanterns, carved cedar, embroidered linens, swirling mosaic patterns, and a quiet desert breeze.

Aisha enters with a burst of laughter and relief, tossing her servant shawl aside and replacing it with her soft royal hijab.

Dora pads in behind her — tired, dramatic — and collapses onto her enormous velvet cushion.

Then she freezes.

Her pupils shrink.

DORA (horror-whisper):

“Aisha... do NOT... move.”

Aisha blinks.

AISHA:  
“...Why?”

DORA:  
“There is a SNAKE.  
ON.  
YOUR.  
SHOULDER.”

The little white snake pokes its head out, blinking innocently.

SNAKE:

“Well hello to you too, Miss Roaring-Claws.”

Dora screams, launching three feet straight up.

DORA:

“It talks! The LIZARD talks! THROW IT OUT OF THE WINDOW.”

SNAKE (funnily offended):

“Lizard? I beg your pardon?... I am Niura, a little harmless snake. And my fangs are purely decorative.”

Aisha bursts into laughter and gently holds them apart.

AISHA:

“Enough, both of you.  
She’s our friend now.”

DORA (jealous):

“Snakes are never friends.  
They slither. They plot. They don’t cuddle.”  
(snarls at the snake)  
“If you ever hurt Aisha, I snap. Understood?”

The snake’s green eyes narrow mischievously.

It sticks out its tongue then curls proudly on Aisha’s pillow.

Dora gasps, scandalized.

Aisha dreamingly looks at the ring on her finger — the Bedouin’s gift.

Oval moonstone. Gold filigree.  
It glows faintly.

Aisha brings it closer to her eyes.

AISHA (soft):

“He said it brings light. Truth. But how does it work?”

Dora snorts loudly.

DORA:

“By being a normal ring, Aisha.  
Maybe if you rub it hard enough, poof, the a giant spirit will appear!”

She theatrically jumps off the bed and rubs her own shadow on the wall, making it look like a monstrous genie.

DORA (big booming voice, posing funnily):

“BEHOLD! I grant you three wishes!  
Wish One: a palace made entirely of... CHICKEN!”

The snake NIURA rolls her eyes and sighs.

Aisha giggles — then pauses.  
She looks closer at the moonstone. It’s swirling faintly under the stone surface.

AISHA:

“Maybe it needs more light?..”

She brings her candle lamp close to the ring. Nothing.

Dora laughs so hard she rolls.

SNAKE NIURA (simply, logically):

“It’s a moonstone, you know.  
Maybe the light it needs is moonlight, not fire.  
Try to catch a moonbeam!”

AISHA freezes.  
Then her eyes widen.

AISHA (whispering to herself):

“Moon... light.  
Of course!”

She dashes to the balcony and extends her hand toward the moon.

The moonstone drinks the light.

A pulse.  
Soft at first — then stronger.

Pearlescent spirals bloom inside the gem.  
A faint, melodic hum rises.  
The air trembles.

DORA freezes mid-shadow performance.

DORA:

“...Aisha...?  
Your ring is humming.”

A filament of golden plasma slips out of the moonstone.

Then another. Then another.

They weave into a floating sphere — then elongate, shaping: arms, legs, torso, hair flowing like molten light, a coat of drifting plasma silk, eyes burning gold.

A DJINN stands before them — elegant and luminous.

AISHA gasps.  
DORA screams, leaping backward and knocking over half her cushion pile.

The DJINN stretches — a cascade of glittering sparks popping off his joints.

DJINN (with mischievous happy smile):  
“Woooo! Finally OUT!  
You have NO idea how cramped that lamp is.  
I’m coughing up sand from the last century.”

Dora peeks from behind a cushion, fur puffed like a cactus.

Aisha can barely breathe. Her eyes shine.

AISHA:  
“You’re... real?...”

DJINN hovers upright, straightens his glowing collar, and grins.

DJINN:  
“Real?”

He floats beside.

DJINN:  
“If I grant you ONE wish, will it make me real enough for you?”

The snake NIURA looks funny bewildered.

SNAKE NIURA:  
“Only one?!..”

He lifts his hand.  
A glowing oud riff fills the room — playful, rhythmic, desert-dance energy.

Dora groans.

DORA:  
“Oh no. Oh no no—Aisha, it’s going to SING—”

And indeed:



The Djinn snaps — a floating plume of glowing calligraphy spins into existence.

He begins to sing.

## MUSICAL NUMBER — “JUST ONE WISH”

DJINN (singing; floating backward gracefully):

“From moonlit chains and ancient plains,  
your call has set me free” —

Golden dunes rise from the floor, swirling around him.

“One spark of light, one ring held tight,  
and you awakened me”.

He taps the ring; constellations burst outward like fireworks.

“I’ve walked with storms, shaped shifting forms,  
I’ve danced on desert air” —

He becomes a silhouette made of whirling sand, then reforms.

“But one wish now, and not one more,  
so choose it with great care”.

He slides past Aisha upside-down, tapping her nose.

Dora yelps and hides behind a pillow fort.

“No palace walls, no silken halls  
can cage a dream that burns” —

Flashes of faraway kingdoms appear — mirage illusions.

“For one wish bold can break the mold  
of fate that twists and turns”.

He twirls; golden ribbons swirl, weaving shapes around Aisha.

Dora attempts to swipe them — they phase through her.

“So think not small or shy or slight,  
think wild as desert breeze” —

He causes tassels, carpets, pillows to lift and dance gently.

“For one wish lifts the veils of night  
and bends the world with ease”.

A glowing world map unfurls in light before Aisha.

He lands softly, bows — the illumination collapses like stardust.

Aisha claps, glowing.

Dora peers from behind a cushion, hair puffed to double size.

DJINN:

“So, Princess...

What’s your one and only wish?”

Aisha gathers her courage.

AISHA:

“I want to see the world.

The real one. Beyond these walls.”

The Djinn smiles — not surprised.

As if he expected exactly that.

He circles her once, fingers trailing golden dust, shaping ethereal shoes from moonlight: semi-transparent, sapphire-edged, gold-filigree lines that shift like constellations, tiny star-bright diamonds glowing at the arches.

He kneels as they touch the floor.

DJINN:

“Behold. The Shoes of Soaring”

Dora approaches cautiously.

DORA (awed whisper):

“...They... actually look royal.”

DJINN:

“They are.  
But dormant.”

Aisha frowns.

AISHA:

“Dormant how?”

The Djinn notices the moonbeam narrowing and clicks his tongue.

DJINN (smirking):

“Oh—moon’s slipping.  
My magic hates being late.”

He drifts closer, lowering his voice in a playful conspiratorial way, eyes glowing with mischief.

DJINN (quiet, teasing):

“A fast hint before curtain-fall...  
They run on the Sands of Time.  
Sand that flows, yet never empties.  
Find it—  
and they’ll wake for you.”

The last word trails as his body dissolves—  
starting at the fingertips, then the hair, swirling into thin ribbons of moonlit  
smoke.  
All of it funnels neatly back into the ring with a soft whump.

Silence.

Aisha rushes to the shoes.

AISHA:

“Sand. Sand... where do I get sand...”

She digs through her childhood treasure box — seashells, marbles,  
scribbled maps.

She finds a seashell with a pinch of old beach sand.

AISHA (hope rising):

“This is from the royal beach! It has to work!”

She sprinkles the sand over the shoes with dramatic flair, plants her feet,  
and strikes a heroic pose.

AISHA:

“Shoes of Soaring!  
By the power of sand...  
FLY!”

She jumps.

THUD.

She winces.

AISHA:

“...Fly?”

She tries again.

THUD.

Dora covers her eyes with a paw.

DORA:

“Well... on the bright side...  
they do make you taller.”

Aisha flops onto the carpet with a groan.

AISHA:

“He said sand...”

The Snake NIURA slithers gracefully down from the vanity and coils  
around one shoe.

SNAKE NIURA (calm, thoughtful):

“He did not say sand.  
He said: sand that never empties.  
That is not ordinary sand.  
It sounds like something... magical.”

Aisha blinks, thinking.

AISHA:

“But where do I find something like that?  
Father never speaks of the old magics.”

She pauses — an idea forming.

AISHA (brightening)

“Unless...

Maestra Saffira.

She’s older than half the paintings in this palace.

If anyone knows where secret magic hides...

it’s her.”

Her eyes light up.

AISHA:

“Tomorrow. We’ll find out.”

Dora rolls onto her back dramatically.

DORA:

“Oh wonderful.

A field trip.

With the snake.

Perfect.”

Aisha hugs the shoes, electricity of excitement buzzing through her.

She blows out the candle.

INT. AISHA’S CHAMBER – NIGHT

Aisha sleeps curled beneath embroidered covers, the moon painting her face with silver patterns through the lattices of the window.

Outside, a cloud drifts over the moon

A small shadow crawls across it.

Eight legs.

Slow.  
Deliberate.

It pauses.

The moon brightens again —  
casting the shadow huge and monstrous across Aisha's wall.

Aisha sleeps peacefully.  
The shadow watches silently.

FADE OUT.  
END of ACT 3.

#### **ACT 4.** **The GUARD OF TIME.**

INT. ROYAL CLASSROOM — MORNING

Morning spills like honey through the carved lattice windows of the Royal Academy's circular classroom.  
Dust motes drift lazily. Scrolls sway on thin strings. Ancient maps glow softly on sandstone walls.

Maestra Saphira stands in the center — tiny, old, wrapped in a thick embroidered shawl covered in abstract floral patterns, constellations, and forgotten sigils.

Aisha sits upright... pretending to take notes.  
Under her desk, Dora swats at the tassels of Saphira's robe with the bored precision of a predator playing with yarn.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA:

"...and that is why the West Wall was raised in the Year of the Camel.  
Aisha. Did you hear a single word?"

AISHA (too fast)

“Yes! Every camel, every wall, every—year.”

Saphira lifts one eyebrow with the weight of ten centuries.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA:

“Aisha.”

Aisha exhales — then leans forward, eyes sharper than before.

AISHA:

“Maestra...  
the walls are only stone.  
What really protects our kingdom?  
Is it true magic? Sand? A... shield?”

The classroom freezes.  
Saphira’s chalk slips — shatters on the floor.

Her voice drops into something ancient.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA (quietly shaken):

“Child...  
that knowledge is meant for royal blood alone.”

Aisha rises slowly.

AISHA:

“Then I must know.  
Father said yesterday I am nearly of age.  
And he said you carry memories older than the palace itself.”

Saphira pauses — breath catches — her expression softens.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA

“He... said that?”



She sits, folding her frail hands.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA

“There is an old legend.

A guardian force — some call it the Guard of Time — said to keep our kingdom safe.

But no one knows where it is.

Only royal blood can see its path...  
when the time arrives.”

Aisha leans in.

AISHA:

“But... what is it? A dune? A relic? Magic sand?”

Saphira chuckles softly — a warm grandmother laugh.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA:

“Oh, if it were as simple as scooping dunes into jars...”

Her tone darkens with mystery.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA:

“I once searched for answers in the Royal Library.

There was a book — a Codex of Architecture —  
beautiful, old book with golden edges...

but the pages were blank.

The legend says only a royal heir may read its secrets.

Perhaps your mother could have.

Perhaps you will.”

Aisha's breath stutters.

Saphira smiles kindly.

MAESTRA SAPHIRA:

“For now... finish your history lesson.”

INT. ROYAL LIBRARY — AFTERNOON

Sunlight spills across towering shelves. Scrolls sleep in carved niches.  
Crystal chandeliers flicker like tiny suns.

Aisha searches feverishly.

Row after row.  
Tome after tome.  
Nothing.

Aisha stacks dozens of opened books on the reading table.

Dora paces around them, tail twitching with growing despair.

DORA

“Herbs... history... sea navigation...  
Aisha, none of these say ‘mystical sand that wakes shoes.’  
Not even close.”

Snake Niura curls around a magnifying lens and peers through it  
theatrically.

SNAKE NIURA (with mischief):

“Oooh. Everything looks enormous.  
Except you, Dora. You remain... delightfully compact.”

DORA (comically pretends offended):

“I am majestic size! Unlike you, tiny noodle!”

Aisha stifles a laugh and keeps searching.

The Snake lifts a kaleidoscope.

SNAKE NIURA

“No wonder our palace patterns are so dizzying.  
Someone definitely used one of these.”

Aisha sighs, flipping through another useless tome.

AISHA

“There must be something...”

Then—

Dora leaps three feet straight into the air.

DORA:

“SPIDER! SPIDER! SPIDER ON THE SHELF!”

Books topple.  
One heavy volume slides off —  
lands at Aisha’s feet.

Aisha kneels and lifts the fallen book.

Ivory cover.  
Golden edges.  
A faded sigil.

AISHA (whispering):  
“...The Codex.”

She opens it.

The pages are blank.

Then letters begin to appear — one by one — curling into golden light.

Dora, watching over Aisha's shoulder, looks utterly baffled.

DORA

"It's just... empty paper. There's nothing written there."

But Aisha sees the words perfectly — glowing gold, curling like vines.

She reads softly:

AISHA

"Where jasmine climbs the starlit stone,  
Find Orion upon the ancient wall.  
Reveal its belt in moonlit line,  
The path shall open to the Guard of Time."

A constellation outline reveals itself.  
Golden dots swirl and settle into three glowing stars, each labeled in delicate shining ink:

Annitak. Alnilam. Mintaka.

Aisha gasps and touches them one by one.

AISHA (whispering the names)

"Annitak... Alnilam... Mintaka..."

Dora looks from the empty page to Aisha with growing concern.

DORA

"Aisha... are you feeling well?"

Niura lifts her head, intrigued.

NIURA (amused whisper)

"She's naming stars correctly. It's Orion's Belt.  
There is no way she knows that on her own."

Dora's eyes widen.

Aisha shoots Niura a mock-scolding look.

Niura shrugs innocently.

The letters fade.

The parchment turns blank again.

AISHA (breathless)

“We have to go. Now.”

She runs — Niura slipping quickly onto her shoulder.

Dora follows, still in comical disbelief.

Behind them,

a spider’s silhouette flickers across the shelves...

...watching.

EXT. PALACE GARDENS — DUSK

Evening stretches blue across the gardens.

Lanterns flicker.

Aisha approaches the long jasmine-covered wall — its petals glowing in moonlight.

AISHA:

“This is the only wall jasmine grows on...

It must be this.”

She pushes aside blossoms and soon notices a single protruding stone, almost like a raised button.

AISHA

“...This one...”

She presses it.

The stone slides sideways like a hidden hatch — revealing a tiny engraved star that glimmers faintly.

Aisha scans the wall.

AISHA (thinking aloud):

“If these stars form Orion’s belt...  
the other two must be in a straight line.”

She moves along the jasmine wall, pushing aside clusters of flowers,  
searching row by row —

—until she finds the second protruding stone.

Another hatch shifts, revealing the second star.

Dora watches, breath held.

Aisha finds the third — perfectly aligned with the others.

When she presses it—

All three star engravings glow as one — bright, moonlit gold.

The jasmine vines quiver.

The wall shudders, then slides open sideways, revealing a hidden arched  
entrance inside the thickness of the wall itself.

Aisha stares in awe.

AISHA (whispering):

“I... never knew there was space inside the walls.”

DORA (wide-eyed):

“I didn’t either... and I live here.”

Moonlight pours into the newly opened corridor —  
revealing a shimmering path within the stone, leading deeper along the  
interior of the palace wall.

Aisha breathes in deeply — scared, excited, brave.

AISHA:

“We go together.”

SNAKE NIURA:

“Oh good.

Finally, a secret corridor.

I was worried this palace held only rugs.”

They step inside the hidden passage.

INT. THE ENCHANTED PASSAGE — NIGHT

The inner corridor is a cathedral of memory.

Rib-like arches curve overhead, carved from warm limestone polished to a living glow.

Murano-glass arabesque mosaics shimmer across the walls, catching glints of moonlight from narrow star-shaped skylight shafts above.

Bioluminescent plants paint the floor edges in turquoise, violet, and rose. Ancient frescoes depict queens, celestial beasts, dunes rising like oceans, and the great myths of Quasar Al’Zaman.

Every step Aisha takes sends luminous ripples across the mosaic tiles — henna-patterns in golden and silvery glow blooming under her shoes.

Dora watches, mesmerized.

DORA (softly)

“It’s like walking on a dream.”

Aisha trails her fingers along a fresco of a crowned woman holding a swirling sand-spiral.

AISHA:

“I think... this place remembers my mother.”

They walk forward until the passage opens into a breathtaking chamber.

INT. THE SANCTUM — THE HOURGLASS OF ZAHRA - NIGHT

The room is semicircular, vast, domed.

The ceiling is a carved stone cupola with intricate arabesque openings — thin, lace-like geometry where moonlight streams through.  
Stars are visible through the filigree, glittering directly above the Hourglass.

In the very center of the chamber stands a podium of two wide steps.

Upon it — towering, majestic, glowing faintly from within —

THE HOURGLASS OF ZAHRA.

Glass thick as armor.  
Gold filigree encasing the top and bottom.  
Inside, star-like sand rises and falls in impossible looping spirals, defying gravity — a soft, eternal heartbeat of the kingdom.

Aisha walks forward slowly, breath trembling.

AISHA (gasping)

“This is what protects our kingdom...  
The Guard of Time, hidden inside our own walls...”

Dora lowers her head, humbled.  
Niura coils lightly around Aisha’s shoulder.

NIURA (hushed):



“That... is real magic.”

Aisha circles the Hourglass, studying every gilded curve.

AISHA:

“It’s sealed everywhere.  
We only need a few grains...”

Niura perks up and immediately slithers off her shoulder.

NIURA:

“Let me check. I’m excellent at climbing!”

She slithers up the glass...gets halfway...loses traction...  
Settles for a rest looking down visibly exhausted.

Before she can complain—

DORA (calls out suddenly):

“Aisha. Look here!”

Aisha and Dora both kneel.

Carved into the lower golden frame is a round depression, adorned with swirling motifs and geometric filigree.

Dora’s eyes widen.

DORA:

“I know this shape...  
Princess — show us your talisman.”

Aisha lifts her locket.

DORA:

“Can’t believe my eyes.  
It’s identical.”

Niura freezes mid-groan. She shoots Dora an utterly betrayed, deadpan face.

NIURA (annoyed, panting)

“...We’re finding secret locks NOW?  
A little early warning would’ve been nice.”

She sighs and slithers the rest of the way down.

NIURA (grumbling, but amused):

“At least sliding was fun.”

Aisha stares, breath shallow.

AISHA (whispering)

“...It’s a key.”

Hands trembling, she fits the talisman into the depression.

CLICK.

Golden light pulses through the Hourglass frame —  
a deep, ancient hum filling the chamber.

The talisman warms in Aisha’s hand; she pulls back with a gasp.

AISHA

“It’s... doing something.”

Inside the locket, a small hidden chamber opens like a gleaming iris.  
A few grains of luminous sand spiral inward, drawn by invisible force.

The talisman releases itself with a soft pop.  
Aisha catches it, breath quick.

She opens it.

Inside, the tiniest whirlpool of star-sand glows like captive starlight.

AISHA (awed):

“This is enough.  
More than enough.”

Dora closes her eyes.

DORA (murmuring):

“May the ancestors forgive us if this was a bad idea...”

Aisha barely hears her.

AISHA:

“Come on! Before anyone notices!”

She clutches the talisman to her chest and heads toward the corridor.  
Niura settles proudly on her shoulder.  
Dora follows — anxious, muttering.

DORA:

“I hope this doesn’t collapse the entire kingdom...”

Just as they disappear into the corridor—

A faint tremor ripples through the Hourglass.

Inside the glass, the sand flickers — one ripple reversing direction for the briefest heartbeat.

Above, through the domed lattice, a small flash of lightning streaks across the sky.

The thunder that follows is soft and distant, wrong for a clear summer night.

They do not look back. The chamber stills.

Then, near the threshold — a single hairline crack creeps across the stone floor, almost invisible in the moonlight.

FADE OUT.

END of ACT 4.

ACT 5. SILENT CITY

INT. AISHA'S BEDROOM – NIGHT

Aisha's bedroom glows in warm lantern-light.

Amber patterns ripple across silk-draped walls.

Curtains sway gently as desert wind drifts in from the balcony.

Aisha doesn't hesitate.

She lifts the moonstone ring, tilting it until it catches a shard of moonlight.

The metal hums.

A ribbon of pale pearlescent light coils upward —

and with a soft, resonant whirl,

the Djinn materializes in a plume of shimmering plasma, his golden hair freezing mid-motion.

His eyes widen.

DJINN

“...You truly found the sand? Already?”

He hovers closer, bewildered but impressed.

Aisha lifts the talisman proudly.

AISHA:

“I told you — I want to see the world.  
Now tell me...Do these shoes really do the magic you promised?  
Or were you just showing off?”

The Djinn gasps, clutching his chest as if mortally wounded.

DJINN (dramatically offended, then smug):

“Showing off?

Princess... I am magic.

When I promise something — it works.”

Aisha rolls her eyes playfully, but her smile is bright with excitement.

Then Aisha opens her talisman and sprinkles the Hourglass sand over her embroidered pale blue glowing shoes.

For a heartbeat — nothing. Then— LIGHT blooms.

Glowing geometric patterns unfurl from the shoes, weaving into a luminous sky-path stretching far across the balcony toward the kingdom walls — gold, sapphire, and rose-gold, shifting like woven starlight.

Dora freezes.

DORA:

“...This looks like the part where royal guards resign.”

Aisha bursts into laughter.

AISHA:

“Come on, Dora! It’s beautiful!”

Niura coils around Aisha’s neck, tail flicking.

Dora steps forward. Her first steps are clumsy, as if the world beneath her feet has changed.

DORA (awed, terrified, funny):

“Why do I always have to go first?..  
This feels like an execution walk!”

Niura winks.

NIURA:

“If you fall, I shall compose a lovely elegy.  
Something truly dramatic...”

The Djinn rises gracefully, hovering with quiet pride.

DJINN (gentle tease):

“No more wishes.  
But if you need me for a quick chat or a small musical performance...”  
(he winks)  
“...you know how to summon me.”

He tosses his hair with proud flair.

DJINN (cont.):

“Good luck, Princess.  
Try not to break anything too important.”

He dissolves into a swirl of moonlight that retreats into the ring.

Aisha touches the ring gently. Then she steps forward onto the sky-path.

EXT. SKY WALK ON THE LIGHTPATH – NIGHT

They all step onto the glowing sky-path.

It thrums beneath their feet — alive, warm, humming with ancient geometry. Patterns ripple outward with every step, fractal arabesques blooming like living embroidery.

Aisha looks around, eyes wide.

AISHA:

“It’s magic! It feels like walking on a river of stars.”

DORA (nervously joking):

“Yes, it’s magic and all... until you look down.”

Aisha laughs softly and looks up instead.

Above them, the stars seem closer — almost within reach.

Niura smiles with sly delight.

NIURA (mischievous):

“Look, Aisha — there is Orion. And the Belt. I bet you don’t remember the star names...”

They all laugh.

Below them, the city gleams with warm lanterns, terraces, and jasmine-scented gardens.

As they walk over the towering palace walls—

AISHA (frowning):

“...The wall. Look.”

A thin crack runs along the outer stone.

Dora narrows her eyes.

DORA

“That crack...  
It wasn’t there last season.”

AISHA

“Maybe just the heat.  
Come — we won’t go far.”

As they descend, the sky-path dissolves behind them like drifting sand.

EXT. THE SILENT CITY of MAYYALA — NIGHT

They land in a wide mosaic plaza.

Before them rises a once-magnificent city: turquoise domes faded and chipped, arched windows carved with lace-like geometry, merchant stalls draped in dusty cloth, colorful homes whose doors are bolted shut, fountains shaped like birds and flowers, long dry.

The silence is unnatural.  
Aisha’s breath catches.

AISHA:

“This city...It must have been beautiful. Something happened here.”

Dora shivers.

DORA:

“I take back everything I said. The sky-walk felt safer than... this.”

They follow a narrow street that opens into a grand fountain courtyard.

At its center stands a colossal peacock fountain, its feathers once encrusted with gemstones — now dulled under a thick layer of pale grey dust.



Aisha kneels and touches the basin.  
Only a thin smear of cloudy water clings to the bottom.

AISHA (softly, pensive):

“...Something is wrong here.”

DORA (in horror):

“Wrong? Aisha — the city is GONE!..  
Where is everyone?”

Niura lifts her head — and the mark on her forehead glows faintly. She turns toward Dora.

NIURA (quietly):

“For the first time I must agree with her. Aisha - it’s not safe here.  
Something watching.”

Aisha stiffens.

A faint, flickering light appears behind a curtain in a nearby house.

AISHA:

“There. Someone’s alive.”

Dora steps protectively beside her.

DORA:

“Or something is.”

The wind shifts — carrying ash. They move toward the glowing curtain.

EXT. AT THE ENTRANCE OF MAYYALLA HOUSE. - NIGHT

A wooden door creaks open only a sliver.

A pair of terrified eyes peek through — the eyes of a woman who has not slept well in years.

WOMAN (whispering low):

“You... you should not be here.  
The Silence catches those who speak too loudly...”

Aisha softens instantly.

AISHA:

“We won’t harm you.  
Please... tell me. What happened to your city?”

The woman hesitates but something in Aisha’s voice, something gentle and royal, unlocks her trust.

The door opens wider. She gestures them inside.

INT. MAYYALA HOUSE – NIGHT

The house was once wealthy: embroidered cushions now torn, faded tapestries, polished floors cleaned obsessively, shelves empty except for cracked pottery, a single tall lantern casting thin shadows

She wears a golden half-mask with small clinking coins.  
A relic from better times.

They sit around a low round table covered with a simple cloth.  
Three figs and two dried dates rest neatly on a tray — the last gifts of a starving home that still insists on hospitality.

Niura lounges elegantly on Aisha’s lap. Dora sits uneasily, scanning every shadow.

The woman pours a few drops of thin rosewater into cups.

WOMAN (trembling whisper):

“The Shadow King happened. He stole our Voicing. We can only whisper now...”

Aisha leans forward.

AISHA:

“Why would he take your voices?”

WOMAN:

“In Mayyala... our water answered our songs.  
Every dawn, the city sang — and the fountains rose and danced with us.  
When he stole our voices... the water dried.”

Aisha’s eyes widen in disbelief.

AISHA:

“Couldn’t your land ask for help? My father—”

The woman shakes her head.

WOMAN:

“We sent a distress letter... four of them. No army ever came.  
But even if they had — what good are swords against shadows?”

Aisha looks down at her hands — confused, shaken, burning with shame  
and quiet courage at the smae time.

Then— A soft cry.

A little girl, no older than four, wanders in rubbing her eyes.  
She does not sob... she cannot sob.

She trembles silently.

GIRL (whispering):

“Mommy... the dreams came back. I can’t sleep... without the song...”

The mother’s voice cracks.

WOMAN:

“Oh, Hala... my little moon... I can’t sing for you anymore.”

Aisha rises and kneels beside the girl, holding her gently.

AISHA (soft)

“My mother used to sing to me... before she died.  
I still remember her lullaby.”

Then she begins to sing.

AISHA’S LULLABY

VERSE 1

Where the wind is soft and gentle,  
Where the moon leans close to hear,  
There my voice will always find you—  
There I keep you safe and near.

VERSE 2

Every soul is tied by silver,  
Threads the moonlight cannot hide.  
Every mother leaves a river  
Flowing quiet by your side.

VERSE 3

If the silence ever frightens,

If the shadows press too tight,  
Let your heart remember singing—  
I will answer with my light.

The woman reaches for her throat — startled.

WOMAN (full voice, shocked):

“...My voice.  
My voice has returned!”

She comes closer to Aisha, tears in her eyes.

WOMAN (cont.):

“Your song healed me!...”

Aisha shakes her head immediately, eyes wide.

AISHA:

“No... no, that’s impossible. I’ve never done anything like this. There is no magic in me.”

The woman grips Aisha’s hands with gratitude.

WOMAN (reverent):

“Princess... there is a kind of magic that isn’t taught.! And it is not born by accident... It comes from blood... or blessing.”

Aisha pulls back, frightened.

AISHA:

“I only wanted to help her sleep...”

The woman touches Aisha’s cheek with a trembling thumb.

WOMAN (quietly):

“And still... something inside you brought a voice back that we thought was lost forever.”

Dora and Niura exchange a look — protective, confused, worried.

WOMAN (urgent whisper):

“If your song restored one home... maybe it can awaken the whole city.”

She opens the door for them, almost pleading.

Aisha stands frozen for a second — terrified of what she might be capable of but Dora nudges her shoulder softly.

DORA (gentle, reassuring):

“Aisha... come.  
If there’s even a chance... we have to try.”

Aisha nods. Still unsure.  
But she steps out into the night.

EXT. PEACOCK FOUNTAIN PLAZA. - NIGHT

They rush into the plaza.

Aisha looks at the silent peacock statue — massive, lifeless — and her courage wavers.

AISHA (quiet, scared):

“I don’t know what to sing.  
What if it doesn’t work again?”

Dora places a paw on her shoulder.

DORA (soft but practical):

“Aisha... you didn’t even know you could do the first thing.  
So don’t think too hard.  
Just... try.”

Niura curls around Aisha’s wrist.

NIURA:

“She is right. Sing, Aisha.  
Whatever comes from your heart”

Aisha closes her eyes and starts to sing.

#### AISHA’S IMPROVISED FOUNTAIN SONG

##### VERSE

Water sleeping under stone,  
Hear a voice you once had known,  
Rise and wash the fear we’ve grown,  
Find your path and flow back home...

##### CHORUS

Wake again, Mayyala city,  
Lift your rivers, find your light,  
Join your hearts, your strength, your pity,  
Chase the shadows from the night!  
Let the fountains sing together,  
Let the dust be swept away —  
May your voice return forever,  
May your spirit rise today!”

Windows open. Frightened faces appear. The fountain trembles.  
A single drop glitters.

Then— BOOOOOOM.

Bioluminescent water erupts skyward, silver-blue like liquid starlight.  
Gemstones blaze. The peacock's tail unfurls in shimmering arcs.

The music swells. People pour into the plaza. One woman begins to sing.  
Then another. Then twenty. Then the entire city.

Aisha spins laughing in the spray, hair wet, glowing.

Dora watches in pure awe.

Niura coils proudly, head high.

The city awakens. The fountains across the city burst to life one by one.  
Lanterns flare awake. Streets glow. People sign and dance in circles  
together on the streets.

Far on the dunes...

A spider-shaped sentinel watches.

Its many eyes glint once. Then it turns and vanishes into darkness.

The Shadow's King knows she is here.

FADE OUT.  
END OF ACT 5.

## **ACT 6.**

### **THE DESERT CROSSING**

EXT. MAYALA — DAWN

Pale dawn pours over the rooftops of Mayala like spilled milk.  
The revived peacock fountain murmurs faint and steady — as if the city is  
breathing again.

INT. FAMILY HOME — DAWN

AISHA wakes curled on woven cushions.



Her voice is slightly hoarse. Her muscles ache from a night spent singing, dancing, healing.

For a moment she blinks, disoriented.

Then she remembers. The restored voices. The diamond water. The whole city singing with her.

Behind her, a soft but urgent pacing.

DORA (hushed, tense):

Aisha... please wake up. If anyone from the palace realizes you're gone, I'll be turned into something decorative. Possibly with tassels.

Aisha sits up, smiling with sleepy wonder.

AISHA:

"Dora... I did something good.

For the first time, I wasn't trapped behind the palace gates. I helped".

DORA:

"Yes, yes, it was miraculous — I cried, they cried, even the snake looked misty — but NOW LET'S RUN".

Aisha shakes her head, calm, changed.

AISHA:

"We can't leave without saying goodbye".

Her fingers brush the talisman. It pulses — warm, alive.

INT. FAMILY HOME — MORNING

The family has prepared a humble yet beautiful breakfast:

– honey-glazed bread

- saffron lentils
- rosewater milk
- dates stuffed with almonds
- pistachio pastries

The WOMAN clasps Aisha's hands with reverent tenderness.

WOMAN:

"You returned our voices.  
Let us share what little we have".

Aisha sits, touched almost to tears.

AISHA:

"You used all this... for me?"

WOMAN (smiling warmly):  
"For the one who brought light back to our home.  
Sit, dear one".

Aisha hesitates.

AISHA:

"I'm not a healer.  
I just... sang".

The woman's expression gentles.

WOMAN:

Some voices carry more than sound.  
Yours carries memory... and something older.  
We have not heard such a voice since—"

She stops.  
Her eyes soften with recognition.

WOMAN (CONT'D):

“—since Zahara passed through this city”.

Aisha freezes.

Her mother's name.

No one outside the palace ever speaks it.

A small tremor passes through Aisha.

DORA notices and presses against her leg soothingly.

NIURA slithers out from Aisha's scarf, inspects a pastry—

NIURA:

“Hmm. Not poisoned. Slightly dry, but edible”.

The family laughs.

INT. FAMILY HOME — CONTINUOUS

The door creaks open.

THE FATHER enters — tall, weathered, gentle-eyed.

He bows respectfully.

FATHER:

“Princess...you restored my daughter's voice. My wife's hope.  
But you cannot remain here. The Shadow King burns the lands nearer to  
his palace.”

Aisha straightens.

AISHA:

“Why?

If Mayala was healed... perhaps I can help the rest of the desert too”.

The father’s face hardens with sorrow.

FATHER:

“Beyond Mayala lies the Deep Sands. The path is swallowed by the storms.

An entire city - the Jewel of the Desert - was reduced to rocks...”

Aisha instinctively touches her sky-shoes.

AISHA:

“They can carry us across”.

The father shakes his head.

FATHER:

“Not into the Deep Sands.

There... magic dies the moment it touches the ground”.

Dora’s fur bristles.

DORA:

“Aisha, we have said our polite goodbyes — home is calling!

Your royal protector is NOT crossing a death desert!”

Aisha places a steady hand on Dora.

AISHA:

“I can’t return yet.

Father knew people were suffering beyond our walls...

and he still didn’t send help.

I need to know why.”

Her voice drops, fragile and trembling.

AISHA (CONT'D):

“And... I want answers about my mother”

The father bows his head.

FATHER:

Then you must seek the Oracle of Ramlat al-Jahwar.  
She alone knows the safe path beneath the Deep Sands”

Dora looks horrified.

DORA:

“Aisha, absolutely not!  
We are not crossing any abyss where even LIGHT refuses to go!”

The father raises a hand gently.

FATHER

You will not walk.  
You will ride the last of the Great Walkers.

Aisha blinks.

AISHA:

“The... what?”

EXT. MAYALA — CITY OUTSKIRTS — AFTERNOON

The sun leans low, warming the dunes with molten gold.

At the boundary where the city ends and sand begins, a massive silhouette waits.

TAMLUN — the Beast of the Dunes — stands calmly, as if carved from the desert itself. His fur shifting like golden dunes, amber eyes soft and intelligent, braided mane with turquoise beads, nomad textiles across his back, regal despite wear

Aisha approaches slowly, breath catching.

AISHA:

“I heard stories about them...  
I thought they were gone.”

The father stands beside her, proud and sorrowful.

FATHER:

“So did we.  
Tamnun is the last calf born before the sands changed.  
When the Shadow King rose, his kin vanished.  
But this one... remembered the old paths.”

Dora peeks from behind Aisha’s leg, horrified and impressed.

DORA:

“He’s... colossal.  
Are we sure he won’t swallow me by accident?”

NURA (smug):

“He has excellent taste. You’re safe.”

TAMLUN kneels, slow and regal — an invitation.

Aisha climbs onto his back without hesitation.  
Dora follows reluctantly.  
Nura wraps around Aisha’s wrist in a snug coil.

Tamlun kneels — a gentle bow.

Aisha climbs onto his back at once; Dora follows reluctantly.

FATHER:

“The desert honors those who travel united.  
Stay close to each other.  
Let him lead.”

Tamlun rises and starts toward the dunes without hesitation.

EXT. OUTER DUNES — CONTINUOUS — AFTERNOON

The father walks alongside them for the first stretch, speaking as they move.

FATHER:

“We once crossed these sands carrying carpets, pearls, instruments...  
And stories from city to city.”

The wind shifts; sand curls like mist around Tamlun’s paws.

FATHER (CONT’D):

“Beyond the Deep Sands lies Ramlat al-Jahwar — the Jewel of the Desert.  
But one year travelers vanished.  
The next year, no one dared to try again.”

Aisha leans forward, focused.

AISHA:

“And the Oracle? She knows why?”

FATHER:

“She sees beneath the sands.  
She can guide you... if you face her test.”

Dora shivers.

DORA:

“Why do all mystical women have tests?  
Can’t anyone offer tea?”

Aisha smiles faintly and squeezes Dora’s paw.

EXT. MOVING DUNES — LATER

The city fades behind them.

Ahead, the dunes move — slow spirals like stirred water.  
Light flickers strangely. Magic feels thin.

AISHA (quiet):  
“The magic really is dying here...”

Nura coils closer; Dora presses into Aisha’s side.

EXT. BLACK RIDGE — SUNSET

A jagged wall of dark stone rises before them.

The father stops.

FATHER:

“This is where I leave you.  
Beyond this point... even your shadow can betray you.”

Tamlun kneels so Aisha and Dora can dismount.

Aisha presses her forehead to Tamlun’s.

AISHA:

“Thank you for carrying us.”



A low, warm rumble answers her.

The father bows.

FATHER:

“Seek the Oracle of Ramlat al-Jahwar. She will show you the path beneath the sands.”

He and Tamlun turn and disappear into the fading light.

Aisha faces the canyon ahead: narrow, glowing with drifting blue-white dust. The air hums with a faint underground river.

DORA:

“Aisha...

We don't have to go in.

No one would blame you.”

AISHA:

“I didn't come only to help the cities.

I'm looking for answers, for truth about my lands, my people... and my mother.”

She takes a breath.

AISHA (CONT'D):

“I'm done hiding behind palace walls.”

She steps into the shimmering dust.

SILENCE falls instantly.

The world shifts — walls pulsing faintly, ground smooth like glass.

Aisha and her companions disappear deeper into the canyon.

INT. CANYON PASSAGE – THE ORACLE’S TEMPLE — DAY

The canyon narrows until even their footsteps vanish.  
A shimmering light flickers ahead.

AISHA:  
(soft, breathless)  
“We’re close...”

They step inside.

INT. THE ORACLE’S SUBTERRANEAN TEMPLE — CONTINUOUS

A hidden cathedral opens around them.  
Sunbeams spill through cracks overhead, falling into a glass-still  
underground lake glowing with teal, sapphire, and rose bioluminescence.

Quartz mosaics scatter the light like drifting constellations.

Mist curls around Aisha’s ankles as they cross floating stepping stones  
above the lake.

DORA:  
(whispering; reverent)  
“This place... feels alive.”

Niura coils tightly, her forehead glowing faint sapphire.

Across the lake, on a floating limestone dais, sits THE ORACLE — elegant,  
ancient, regal.

Her layered peacock silks shimmer. Her silver hair is braided with  
iridescent ornaments. Golden bracelets chime softly.  
Her eyes open — steady, unreadable.

A low hum vibrates through the chamber.

ORACLE:  
(gentle, resonant)

“You carry a long journey on your shoulders, Princess of Quazar al Zaman.”

Dora flinches and hides.

DORA:

(mutters)

“She sees everything. Even my sins...”

Aisha steps forward, steady but cautious.

AISHA:

“I seek passage beyond the Deep Sands. I must reach the Shadow King.”

The Oracle regards her — smiling warmly, but with something sharper beneath it.

ORACLE:

“Not all paths welcome those who walk burdened.

The passage accepts only those who carry nothing.”

AISHA:

“But I left everything behind. My crown. My home. I’m not carrying anything.”

The Oracle tilts her head.

ORACLE:

(smiling softly)

“Princess... you carry the greatest treasure of all.

Your memories hold a song — a lullaby of your mother, the Great Queen of Nur.”

Aisha freezes. Her hand tightens around the talisman.

AISHA:

(quiet, fragile)

“It’s all I have left of her...”

Niura glows brighter — a pulse of warning.

The Oracle extends a graceful hand.

ORACLE:

“I do not ask for the gold.  
Only for what sleeps inside it.  
Give me the song, and the passage will open.”

Aisha hesitates, tears forming.

AISHA:

“If I give it up... I lose the only piece of her I remember.”

The Oracle leans forward — gentle, reassuring, persuasive.

ORACLE:

“Memories are not trapped in melodies. Letting go does not erase her.  
It frees you to walk your true path.”

Niura suddenly tightens around Aisha’s wrist.

NURA:

(soft, warning whisper)

“Aisha... something doesn’t feel right. Why would she need your mother’s song?”

The Oracle turns her gaze onto Niura — serene, patient.

ORACLE:

“Withheld truth cannot be reached without a price.  
The passage tests what you cling to most.  
This is the toll all travelers face, Princess — not only you.  
You may walk away... keep your comfort... your memories.  
But if you seek the truth about your mother...  
and about your lands...  
the Passage is the only road through the Deep Sands.”

A painful beat.

Aisha inhales shakily.

Then she steps forward and lifts the talisman.

The Oracle does not touch it — she raises a single finger.

ORACLE:

“Sing. One last time.”

Aisha closes her eyes... and sings.

A tender melody. A mother’s warmth. A memory of being held.

“Every soul is tied by silver,  
Threads the moonlight cannot hide.  
Every mother leaves a river  
Flowing quiet by your side...”

The cave listens, light swirls, the lake glows brighter.  
The mosaics shimmer like constellations ignited.

As the last note trembles — silver light pulls from Aisha’s lips, drawn into  
the talisman like living smoke.

The locket snaps shut.

Aisha gasps.

AISHA:

“I... I can’t remember how the next line goes...”

For a fraction of a second the Oracle’s eyes gleam with hunger.  
A sharp smile flickers. Gone instantly.

ORACLE:

(soft, serene)

“Your memory sleeps safely now.  
And you walk unburdened.”

Ancient henna-like patterns ignite across the cavern walls — glowing gold,  
alive with ancient magic.

Niura shivers violently, her glow now bright sapphire.

NURA:

(barely audible)

“Aisha... something’s wrong...”

Aisha barely hears her — she’s staring at the opening wall.

THE PASSAGE OPENS

Stone peels away like fabric.

A radiant corridor appears — sand glowing from within, lit as if by trapped starlight.

ORACLE:

“Walk now, Princess. And remember — without your song, the desert will test you... with illusions of light.”

Aisha grips her now-dark talisman.

She steps into the glowing corridor. Dora follows, trembling.

Niura coils tightly, her forehead glowing like a warning flame.

They vanish into the light — toward the Mirage City.

FADE OUT.

END OF ACT 6.

**ACT 7.**

**MIRAGE CITY**

INT. MIRAGE PASSAGE — NIGHT

The glowing corridor fades behind them.

A vast chamber spreads outward — so immense it seems to contain an entire world.

Soft golden mist drifts like enchanted dust.

The ground is pale velvet sand, warm and impossibly soft.

Aisha steps forward—

And the world opens.

#### EXT. MIRAGE CITY — CONTINUOUS

A city of impossible beauty stretches into a horizon that shouldn't exist inside a cavern.

- Towers of mother-of-pearl and rose sandstone, domes shimmer with mosaic tiles reflecting shifting constellations overhead, fountains shaped like colossal flowers erupt in spirals of jewel-colored water and light.

Above them —the sky glitters with millions of constellations brighter and more vivid than night.

Aisha stops, breath stolen.

AISHA:

(soft, awed)

“Ramlat al-Jawhar...

The Jewel of the Desert.

Is this a vanished kingdom?”

Niura glows faintly — not admiration, but warning.

NURA:

(quiet disbelief)

“The kingdom they said was reduced to rocks?..”

Dora’s ears tilt back.

DORA:

(low, uneasy)

“Maybe those rumors were lies. Anyone sees ruins here?..”

Aisha steps forward, mesmerized.

AISHA:

“Maybe we should explore more to understand what happened here”

EXT. MIRAGE CITY — GRAND MARKET — NIGHT

They enter a breathtaking luxury bazaar where rivers of white sand flow like carpets. Henna-patterned motifs glow underfoot in soft amber and sapphire.

People glide by in luxurious silks and veils.  
Their movements feel weightless, almost dreamlike — as though gravity is selective here.

EXT. JEWELRY QUARTER — CONTINUOUS

Aisha pauses at a jewelry stand overflowing with gold, pearls, moonstone charms, and talismanic symbols.

A handsome merchant — silk-clad, layered robes, bracelets tinkling — smiles warmly as she admires an intricate infinity charm.

MERCHANT:

“Your eye is sharp, Princess.

This charm protects travelers of noble heart. It would suit you.”

Aisha touches it gently.

AISHA:

(smiling, polite)

“It’s beautiful... but I’m afraid I carry no coin.”

The merchant laughs softly.

MERCHANT:

“For guests of the Mirage City?

Beauty is a gift, not a purchase.”

Aisha blushes slightly but shakes her head.

AISHA:



“Even gifts must be deserved.  
Thank you... but I should keep moving.”

She smiles softly and steps away.

Dora watches the merchant suspiciously.

DORA:

(low)

“Too many smiles in this place. Makes my fur twitch.”

Niura glows faintly in agreement.

#### EXT. LUXURY FABRIC COURT — CONTINUOUS

They approach a stall draped in shimmering celestial fabrics.  
Constellation-embroidered silks ripple in the wind like living star maps.

A stallkeeper — a striking woman in lilac pearlescent robes, head coins chiming, face half-veiled — watches them with quiet interest.

Aisha stops at a small side-table filled with ornate glass perfume bottles — shapes like moons, teardrops, little stars.

She picks up one round blue bottle.  
She uncorks it and inhales softly.

A distant, aching warmth crosses her face.

AISHA:

(soft, emotional)

“My mother used to wear a scent like this...”

The Scent-Mistress steps closer .

SCENT-MISTRESS:

“You recognize fragrances deeply.  
Most passersby only smell flowers...  
You smell memories.”

Aisha blushes slightly, closing the bottle carefully.

AISHA:

“I kept her empty perfume bottles for years...”

The woman’s eyes brighten.

SCENT-MISTRESS:

“Then you must try something rare.

A scent not found in any desert... any palace or any kingdom.”

She lifts a pink, luminous bottle — shaped like a celestial apple.

SCENT-MISTRESS:

“This is called Dreamveil.

One breath, and the noise of the world fades.”

Aisha leans in, intrigued.

AISHA:

“May I?”

SCENT-MISTRESS:

“Of course.

It was made for royalties like you”

She sprays a soft mist in the air.

Aisha inhales—

Her expression softens instantly. Shoulders relax. Her pupils widen slightly.

She looks dazed... dreamy.

AISHA:

(soft exhale)

“Oh... that’s heavenly...”

She lifts the perfume bottle and sprays a bit on her scarf.

Niura sneezes - loud - and her eyes widen.

NIURA:

"I feel dizzy from that luxury perfume. Maybe too much luxury for my nose!"

The Scent-Mistress smiles beneath her veil - mysterious indecipherable.

Dora steps closer, ears tilted.

DORA:

(worried whisper)

"Aisha... are you alright?"

Aisha blinks slowly and smiles.

AISHA:

"I... yes.

Just... light. And happy.. Happy to be here."

Niura coils tighter on Aisha's shoulder, glowing brighter. She exchanges a stunned look with Dora.

Aisha turns—

And stands face-to-face with a tall figure.

EXT. MARKET — THE VIZIER APPEARS — CONTINUOUS

The Vizier of Mirage glides forward — robes drifting like smoke, gold-threaded beard shimmering.

He bows low.

VIZIER:

"Princess...

Our Prince has seen your arrival.

He requests your presence in the palace."

Aisha steadies her breath, still affected by the perfume.

AISHA:

“Your Prince... watches strangers?”

VIZIER:

“Only those whose presence bends the light around them.  
He believes you do not travel here by accident.”

Dora steps sharply between them.

DORA:

(growling low)

“We are here to pass through. Nothing more.”

The Vizier’s smile is soft, practiced, hypnotic.

VIZIER:

“And yet...

why pass through power, when power wishes to meet you?”

Aisha looks up at the towering palace — shimmering like a dream.

The perfume’s haze still clings to her.

AISHA:

(uneasy, but drawn in)

“Is he... strong?”

VIZIER (making a wide proud gesture):

“Look at his Kingdom! He protects it from every shadow.  
He bends beasts, wind, and illusion to his command”.

A beat. Aisha’s eyes flicker with hope — the kind that blinds.

AISHA:

“...Take me to him.”

Dora's jaw drops.

DORA:

"Oh stars. That's your worst idea ever."

But Aisha has already stepped forward.

The Vizier gestures gracefully toward the palace.

They follow.

INT. PALACE OF MIRAGE — CONTINUOUS

They step into a palace of breathtaking surreal beauty: giant doors shaped like unfurling petals, arabesque latticework glowing from within, fountains shaped like lanterns spilling liquid light, pearlescent floors swirling like living marble, walls painted with shifting frescoes of moonlit dunes

Attendants glide forward — soft as shadows, graceful as dancers.

VIZIER:

"She cannot meet the Prince as a traveler.  
She must be seen as whom she truly is."

The Scent-Mistress steps beside him.

SCENT-MISTRESS:

(smiling beneath veil)  
"Let me prepare her."

Two palace guards step forward, blocking Dora and Niura.

GUARD:

"Animals stay. No panther. No serpent."

Dora bristles.

DORA:

(offended)

“I am not ‘animals,’ I am her royal — ”

Aisha touches her head gently.

AISHA:

“It’s alright. Wait for me here.”

Niura coils tightly around Dora’s neck instead — the first time she’s ever left Aisha.

NURA:

(whispering)

“We won’t leave this door.”

Aisha is led away.

INT. PALACE CORRIDOR — CONTINUOUS

Left alone, Dora and Niura walk the corridor restlessly.

DORA:

“This is wrong.

It’s all too perfect.

Nobody is this happy. Even happy people aren’t this happy.”

Niura glows faint sapphire.

NURA:

“This place looks like paradise, but it feels like a trap.”

They slip away from the main hall, investigating—

A courtyard of impossible beauty: fountains shaped like blooming flowers, petal-dome roofs, delicate curtains.

But no birds, no insects, not even a real wind.

DORA:

(whispering, unsettled)

“I don’t like this...”

Where is she? They said she'd only be a moment—”

Niura slides ahead, her tail tense.

NURA:

“Waiting is a trap. Searching is survival.”

Dora huffs, then nods.

DORA:

“...That’s actually the first smart idea you’ve had today.”

Niura gives her a look — severe, but with a glimmer of humor.

Dora softens.

DORA:

(tender, low)

“Thank stars you’re with me.”

Niura coils around her shoulder, protective.

They continue.

INT. SIDE CORRIDOR — MOMENTS LATER

A faint murmuring hum echoes down the far hall — the sound of a crowd.

Dora freezes.

DORA:

“Did you hear that?”

Niura lifts her head sharply.

NURA:

“That’s... applause. And chanting.”

Dora’s eyes widen.

DORA:

“Aisha.”

They race toward the sound.

INT. ARENA SIDE ENTRANCE — CONTINUOUS

They emerge through a carved archway—

—and stop dead.

A colossal hippodrome-like arena stretches before them far into the dunes. Rectangular, enormous, with multiple tracks of golden sand.

A semicircular podium sits carved into the towering Palace wall, with giant heavily ornate Gates behind.

Dora’s fur rises.

DORA:

“...What in is THIS?”

Niura’s glow strengthens.

NURA:

“A showground. For a BIG show.”

Dora looks toward the central podium — her breath stops.

A palanquin of glowing crystal petals rises from the stage floor. Inside sit the Vizier, Scent-Mistress and.. Aisha. She looks totally transformed.

Her gown is celestial royal blue silk in shifting constellations, her hair is crowned with a delicate diamond filigree tiara. Her new scarf is sky-blue silk embroidered with henna-like constellations, tipped with micro-diamonds. Her face is serene, radiant... and distant.

She looks like a princess carved from starlight — beautiful, unreachable, hypnotized.

DORA (whispers to herself in disbelief):



“Aisha...?”

She nudges Niura.

DORA:

“Do you see her too? Or is this some trick?”

Niura narrows her eyes.

NURA:

“No trick. That is her. But she looks ... different”

Dora with Niura on her shoulders rush forward.

They climb the palanquin steps.

DORA:

“Aisha?”

Aisha turns, smiling — soft and dreamy.

AISHA:

“Oh... there you are. Isn't it beautiful?”

DORA:

(whisper-shouting)

“What in the dunes is happening here? Is this— is this a marriage ceremony?!...”

Aisha looks at them with a dreamy, gentle smile.

AISHA:

“No, Dora... Not a marriage. At least, not yet..”

Dora leans in, horrified but relieved.

DORA:

“Okay good, because I didn't bring a gift.”

Aisha giggles softly — not quite like herself.

Niura touches her wrist, worried.

NURA:

“You are acting weird... What have they placed on you?”

Before Aisha can answer— A trumpet blast shakes the arena.

The giant petal gate parts.

## THE PRINCE’S ENTRANCE

The Prince strides out beneath a rain of golden light.

He wears flowing white and silver, his cape a cascade of translucent silk.  
He raises his arms, and the roaring crowd instantly falls silent.

His voice carries like a spell.

PRINCE:

“Blessings upon all gathered here—  
for tonight, strength and unity rise before your eyes.”

The nobles applaud wildly.

PRINCE (continuing):

“Today, we welcome a guest whose destiny shines beyond the dunes.  
A daughter of light...  
who may one day join strength with ours.”

Aisha lowers her gaze — shy, regal, enthralled.

Dora’s eyes narrow.

DORA:

“Join... strength?.”

The Prince spreads his arms.

PRINCE:

“Let the trials of power begin.  
And let our honored Princess witness what greatness can be...  
when kingdoms stand united.”

He snaps his fingers.

THE SHOW BEGINS.

Drums shake the sand.  
Hatches open beneath the podium.

From the shadows emerge—

The THUNDER PANTHERS

Five times larger than a panther. Sleek bodies with shimmering scale-like skin. Electric-blue streaks pulse under their fur.

They sprint almost the length of the arena— so fast they blur like lightning.

The Prince sings:

PRINCE (singing):

“Beasts of the storm, born of thunder’s command,  
Bend to the whisper that steadies the land...”

The thunder-panthers halt as one — kneeling to him.

The audience explodes in cheers.

Dora’s jaw drops.

Niura glows nervously.

Hatch doors shift— A squad of massive HIGHLAND LYNXES emerges.

Their fur is enormous plumes of winter-white tipped in gold, their paws are thick, powerful and silent.

Warriors of royal army march beside them in perfect step, adorned in luxurious armor.

PRINCE (CONT'D):

“Fangs of the mountains, silent as night,  
Stand at my side as keepers of might.”

The lynxes roar in harmony. Spectators stomp the ground in frenzy.

Niura murmurs:

NURA:  
“These are not tamed.  
They are... bound.”

The arena dims.

A deep rumble.

Then — Four creatures burst from the hatches at full speed:

Bodies of sleek racing canines, short fur with zebra-like glowing burgundy red stripes on their necks.

Powerful legs, folded wings tucked like hidden blades along their sides.

They are MAZ-KHARS  
They run like fire streaking across the sand.

Halfway down the track —

WHOOSH —

They unfurl their molten-glass-patterned wings, catching the air —  
trails of shimmering light behind them as they glide over the arena.

PRINCE (CONT'D):

“Run with the wind, in the air ascend,  
Strength upon strength when destinies blend—  
From earth into sky, let power take flight,  
Together we blaze through the heart of the night!”

The beasts soar overhead.

The crowd screams in euphoria.

Dora stumbles.

Aisha watches, starry-eyed.

The music softens.

Two hatches open beneath the gate.

Out emerge two more enormous MAZ-KHARS —  
larger than the others, shimmering like constellations made flesh.

Their wings: patterned with molten-glass fractals. Their eyes: deep,  
ancient, gentle.

The Prince smiles at Aisha.

PRINCE:

“Princess... Let us ride as one. See the world as it should be seen.”

Aisha breathes shakily.

Dora grabs Niura.

DORA:

“She is NOT getting on that thing—  
She is— AISHA— DON’T—”

Aisha walks forward and gives her hand to the Prince who helps her to  
mount gracefully.

Then the Prince mounts the other.

The crowd roars.

EXT. SKY ABOVE THE ARENA — CONTINUOUS

The beasts sprint, sand spraying like gold. Their wings unfurl and they ascend.

Aisha's scarf streams behind her. Her gown sparkles with constellations. The dunes below stretch like liquid gold.

She looks both terrified and awestruck.

The Prince sings softly into the wind his final refrain.

PRINCE (singing):

“Two paths now crossing, two lights now aligned,  
Carried by winds where our destinies bind...”

They circle the arena in a wide, elegant arc—  
descending in a soft glide, landing side by side on the arena sand.

The crowd erupts with ecstatic cheers.

EXT. ARENA — MOMENTS LATER

The Prince steps closer, lowering his voice.

PRINCE:

“Princess Aisha...Tell me.  
Will you remain here awhile?  
Will you stand with me...and join our strengths?”

Aisha looks up at him.  
Her eyes soft, her breath slow, entranced.

Before she can answer—

DORA (shouting from below):

“AISHA! blink twice if you need help!”

Aisha turns her head toward them. Then she smiles, dreamy, as if she didn’t hear.

NIURA:

(terrified whisper)

“Oh no. She’s gonna say yes. SHE’S GONNA SAY YES.”

The Prince raises a brow, amused.

PRINCE:

“Your companions seem... spirited.”

Dora bares her teeth.

DORA:

“You seem... punchable.”

The audience laughs lightly.

The Prince ignores Dora and lifts Aisha’s hand gently.

PRINCE:

“Stay, Princess Aisha. Together, we could reshape kingdoms.”

Aisha opens her mouth—

And then—

THE RING WARMS.

A sharp heat slices through her finger.

Aisha gasps, flinching.

A ripple of sapphire sparks glows around the ring.

And—

WHOOSH—

A burst of golden flame erupts beside her.

The Djinn materializes.

Gasps sweep the arena.

The Prince recoils, scandalized.

PRINCE:

“What— WHAT is that creature doing here?!”

The Djinn floats between them protectively.

DJINN:

(grave, urgent)

“Aisha! Wake up. We need to go!”

Aisha frowns, disoriented.

AISHA:

“I... I am awake. Why are you even here? What...”

DJINN:

(cutting her off)

“Look. Look at the sky!”

The Prince steps in front of Aisha.

PRINCE:

(firm, authoritative)

“Do not listen to him. He is a desert trick.  
He clouds your thoughts—”

DORA:

“He clouds NOTHING compared to YOU, silk-boy!”

The Djinn points upward.



DJINN:

“Aisha, answer me this.

Do you recognize any constellation above us?”

Aisha looks at the shimmering dome of stars.

Her breath catches. Not a single recognizable pattern, not even Orion’s belt, visible from everywhere in the Kingdom.

AISHA:

(whisper)

“...I... I don’t. What .. does it all mean?..”

The Prince steps closer, anger rising.

PRINCE:

“You dare poison her mind?”

The Djinn doesn’t flinch.

DJINN:

“I don’t poison. I reveal.”

And with a sweeping arc of his arm—

BOOM—

A surge of golden plasma CRACKS upward, smashing into the false sky—

The dome SHATTERS like glass. Light erupts. A hole torn open and through it:

THE REAL NIGHT SKY.

It’s dark, endless and filled with true constellations. Orion shimmers high above them.

Gasps ripple through the arena. But now the gasps warp.

The applause falters. The crowd flickers: the nobles’ robes begin to ripple like smoke, faces blur, bodies shimmer.

Their silhouettes almost turn semi-transparent.  
The Prince staggers back, horrified, looking at his own hands as they begin to fade.  
His mantle trails behind him in dissolving ribbons of smoke.

The Djinn floats to Aisha.

DJINN:  
“Aisha! This place was never real. It’s a Mirage city build to trap you!”

The illusion falters violently. The podium trembles.  
Curtains dissolve into dust. The arena ground cracks beneath them.

The Djinn grabs Aisha by the waist, lifting her—  
and sweeps up Dora with his other arm as if they’re weightless.

DJINN:  
“Hold on.”

They SHOOT upward toward the shattered sky—

Dora clings to him screaming, Niura wrapped around her neck.  
They burst through the hole.

EXT. RAMLAT AL-JAWHAR LANDS — NIGHT

The Djinn lowers Aisha, Dora, and Niura gently onto a warm dune beneath the true star-filled sky.

Dora tumbles, gasping.

Niura scrambles off her, scandalized.

Aisha sits up, dazed, breath trembling.

As soon as the hem of her celestial gown touches real sand—

it dissolves into drifting blue dust. Her original traveling caftan shimmers back into place.

They stay on the dusty ground for a long quiet beat, taking in the reality of what just happened.

The Djinn floats beside them, softly glowing.

Before them stretches the vast, desolated remains of what once was the Gem of the Desert:

Endless tall stone formations carved hollow with round openings—  
tiny flickering lights inside like abandoned candle homes.  
Dried plants sway in the breeze.  
Shimmering dunes roll under starlight.  
Enormous tall rocks faces still show faint peeled paint and shattered mosaics.

FADE OUT.  
END OF ACT 7.

## **ACT 8.**

### **THE REVELATION.**

EXT. RAMHAT AL JAWHAR - CLIFF EDGE — NIGHT

The Djinn stands near the edge of a cliff.  
No longer proud, no longer floating with crossed arms. He walks.

His orange-gold plasma glow has faded to a tired ember.  
He runs a hand across a broken stone statue — once beautiful, now dust.

Aisha call out softly.

AISHA (quiet, sincere):  
“I almost stayed. You saved us...”

The Djinn flinches at her gratitude. He looks down, shame passing briefly over his face.

DJINN:

"I couldn't watch him trap you.

If you stayed... your memories would have faded.

You wouldn't even remember the name of your own Kingdom..."

Aisha sighs. Dora, unusually quiet, approaches and gently nuzzles Aisha's arm.

Aisha rises, brushing sand from her knees.

She looks out at the vast, desolate landscape — rock formations stretching like fossilized waves toward the horizon.

AISHA

"...This was a city?"

The Djinn still does not turn.

DJINN

"It was The Jewel of the Desert.

Before the Shadow King stole the color from the stone."

He looks like someone carrying a wound too old to speak of.

DJINN (CONT'D):

"Come. We need shelter before the night freeze sets in."

INT. HOUSE IN THE ROCKS - NIGHT.

He leads them up a winding, eroded staircase carved into the cliff.

A "Second Layer" dwelling, tucked high in the canyon wall.

Dora sniffs the doorway suspiciously.

DORA:

"Just to be clear...

the Princess is sleeping in a hole in a rock wall?"

AISHA (smiling softly):

"It's not a hole, Dora. It's a house."

Inside is unexpectedly cozy.

The Djinn has used a whisper of magic to soften the space:  
Thick woven Bedouin rugs warming the stone,  
A small clay fire pit flickering with orange glow,  
Desert plants in clay pots,  
Semi-transparent white curtains drifting gently in the doorway,  
A breathtaking view of real dunes and semi dried lake glistening beneath  
real stars

Aisha sits by the fire, hugging her knees.

She looks toward the constellation of The Hunter.

AISHA (whisper):  
“It feels peaceful here. I love this sky.”

Niura uncoils from Aisha’s neck and settles onto a warm rug.

NIURA:  
“It has a heartbeat, Princess...but we might not have ours for long.  
We know the truth now. The Shadow King is real. We should return. Your  
father can bring the army.”

Aisha’s expression darkens.

AISHA:  
“My father knew. He knew about this darkness... and he stayed behind his  
walls. He acted out of fear. I won’t be like him.”

She touches her Talisman, pensive.

AISHA (CONT’D):  
“There’s something missing.  
Something my father never told me.  
I saw his face...  
Something snapped in him long ago.  
I need to know why.”

The Djinn stands near the curtains, eyes reflecting the moonlight.

He turns to her.

DJINN:

“Princess...

I need to speak with you. Alone.”

Dora instantly bristles.

DORA:

“Absolutely not. I object. I mind.

After the Hypnotic Perfume City, I don’t trust anyone who floats.

I’m staying right here.”

Aisha strokes Dora’s head gently.

AISHA:

“Dora... he saved us. We’d still be staring at fake stars without him.

Let me go.”

Dora grumbles, circles three times, then flops dramatically.

DORA:

“Fine. But if you scream, I’m eating him. Plasma or not.”

Aisha follows the Djinn outside, down the winding steps to a shimmering azure lake surrounded by a ruined plaza.

Once majestic — Nabatean carvings, delicate minarets — now broken bones of a forgotten empire.

The Djinn stops at the center of a cracked mosaic.

DJINN (quiet):

“I lied to you, Aisha.”

Aisha stiffens.

AISHA:

“Lied to me?... About what?”

DJINN

“About the rules. I said I could grant only one wish.  
The truth is... I had three. I kept the other two for myself.”

Aisha bursts into relieved laughter.

AISHA:

“That’s it? That’s nothing!  
You gave me shoes, you helped me see the truth. Keep your wishes.”

His face tightens.

DJINN:

“It’s not nothing. Because I’m going to use the second one...  
right now.”

He closes his eyes.

SNAP.

A soft golden glow forms around him, swirling like stardust.

The plasma skin fades, his feet touch the ground, his shape shifts.

When the light clears—a human stands there with a soft faint glow  
around.

He is young and handsome. His eyes are dark and saddened.  
Clothed in a royal kaftan of deep maroon and burgundy, embroidered with  
ancient gold patterns.

Aisha gasps, hand to her mouth.

AISHA

“You... you’re not a Djinn at all.”

PRINCE:

(soft, aching)

“I was the ruler of this world. This was my home, Aisha. Before the shadows came.”

Soft music rises — oud strings carried by the desert wind.

The Prince lifts his hand.

PRINCE (singing):

“Before the shadow stole our dawn,  
Before my people’s hope was gone,  
This land was light, this land was peace,  
A kingdom warm as golden fleece.”

As he walks past a ruined arch, he brushes it.

WHOOSH—

The stones pull together, rebuilding into a pristine gateway.  
Vines bloom with glowing bioluminescent flowers.

PRINCE (singing):

“But when he rose in poisoned night,  
He turned our days to endless fright...  
And so he bound my soul by chain,  
To serve his darkness, bear his pain.”

He sweeps a hand over the ground.  
A shadow-play appears — the invasion, the fall, the king’s enslavement.

He turns to Aisha, voice softening, warm.

PRINCE (singing):

“He made me Jinn, he stole my throne,  
He left my people turned to stone.  
I roamed in silence, torn apart...  
Until your courage healed my heart.”



Aisha steps toward him, eyes shining.

She begins to sing.

AISHA (singing):

“I walked the world beyond my walls,  
I felt its wounds, I heard its calls.  
You showed me stars I’d never seen —  
And now you stand where hopes begin.”

She touches a ruined fountain.

Light-water erupts, flowing like liquid diamonds across the plaza.

He takes her hand.

They begin a slow, floating dance above the glowing water.

Flowers bloom as they pass.

Cacti open into radiant blossoms.

The broken city reclaims its former glory around them.

BOTH (singing):

“So take my hand, though paths are dark,  
We’ll light the sand with just one spark.  
Two souls choose to mend as one,  
To heal the lands with hope and love .”

They end close — breath mingling, hearts open.

And then—

CRASH.

The magic collapses.

Water fades into dust. Flowers shrivel. Arches crack and fall. Light extinguishes.

The Prince buckles, glow around him dims and he transforms back into the DJINN.

Aisha rushes toward him.

AISHA:

“Why did it stop?  
Can’t you bring it back?”

The DJINN lowers his head.

DJINN:

(weak, sorrowful)

“The Shadow King is too powerful. I cannot undo what he did.  
Only he can.”

Aisha, still glowing, steps toward him.

AISHA:

“Then we find him. We will find a way to make him restore your form and  
your city”

DJINN:

(whispering)

“No.”

He turns away, fists clenched so tightly the plasma turns almost red.

DJINN:

“I am sorry, Aisha... I will use my last wish to bring you—and everyone—  
back home.”

Aisha frowns, confused and hurt.

AISHA:

“Wait, what??.. No. We need to help your people. We’re a team.”

His voice cracks.

DJINN:

“The Shadow King made a condition.  
But you... you don’t know the price.”

He turns slowly, tears streaming down his face.

DJINN (CONT'D):

"He promised to restore my city... and make me human again... only if I brought you to him. Or your Talisman."

Aisha steps back. Her hand flies to the necklace at her chest. The magic of the dance shatters like glass.

AISHA:

(shaking her head)

"No. No, I don't believe you. You're saying this to scare me. You want me to go back home because it's dangerous. But you know I won't leave you."

His voice tears out of him like a wound:

DJINN:

"Aisha — THIS IS THE TRUTH!"

He steps forward, desperate.

DJINN:

"He wants your Talisman because he knows something is inside it. Do you remember your song?"

Aisha's eyes widen.

AISHA:

"...I gave it to the Oracle."

DJINN

"Exactly. The magic of your song is trapped in the metal now. The Shadow King knows this. With your Talisman... his power becomes limitless."

He swallows hard.

DJINN (CONT'D):

"Maybe you are the only one who can stand against him..."

but not here. Not like this.  
You need to return home. Gather your father's troops.  
Without your song, without your memories... you're helpless."

Aisha turns toward the dark horizon.  
Something fierce ignites in her chest.

AISHA:  
"We come too far to retreat."

She walks past him toward the cave.

The Djinn floats low behind her, head bowed, drowning in shame.

Only the wind dares speak.

INT. HOUSE IN THE ROCKS - NIGHT.

They reach the cave entrance.  
Dora rushes out immediately, all instinct and tension.

DORA:  
"Aisha! What happened? You were gone too long!"

Aisha rests a soft hand on her head — but her fingers tremble.

AISHA:  
"...Let's go inside."

Dora's eyes narrow at the Djinn.  
Inside, Niura lifts her head from a rug.

NIURA:  
"Oh, Aisha... that look.  
I leave you alone once and disaster finds you.  
What is it? Did we lose the map? Something worse?"

Aisha swallows, unable to speak.

She looks at the Djinn.

AISHA:

“...Will you tell them? Or should I?”

The Djinn drifts forward, unable to meet their eyes.

DJINN:

“I... brought Aisha here because...  
because the Shadow King orders me to.”

DORA (screaming):

“WHAT?!”

She leaps, cornering the Djinn against the stone wall.  
Her teeth gleam in the firelight.

DORA

“No more jokes. No riddles.  
Say one more lie and I WILL eat you.”

The Djinn doesn't fight.  
He simply lowers himself, defeated.

DORA (to Aisha, furious whisper):

“I told you! I told you something was wrong with him!”

Aisha steps between them.

AISHA:

“Dora... stop.”

Her voice is gentle, yet firm.

AISHA:

“He had his reasons. He tried to save his land.”

DORA:

“He tried to sell YOU!”

Aisha flinches.

Niura slithers forward thoughtfully.

NIURA:

“Did he tell you what the Shadow King truly wants?”

DJINN:

“He wants her Talisman. The one her mother gave her.”

Dora points a paw at Aisha.

DORA:

“That’s it! We’re done! We’re going home right now!”

DJINN:

“That is what I tell her. I still have one wish left. I can return you all.”

DORA:

“Then DO IT! Right, Aisha?!”

Aisha looks at him torn.

AISHA:

“...But what happens to your people?  
To you?”

He looks away.

DJINN:

“I don’t want anything bad to happen to you, Aisha.  
You already risk more than you should.”

Niura hisses sharply.

NIURA:

“Aisha... he is the servant of the Shadow King. All of this is a trap!”

Aisha walks to the house round opening. The stars reflect in her eyes.

AISHA

“We move forward. Together. Whatever came before is behind us now.”

DORA:

“But what if it’s another trap?!”

AISHA:

“There is something in me that believes.”

Niura sighs — then smirks unexpectedly.

NIURA:

“...If he wants the Talisman, give him one. Just not the real one.”

Dora groans.

DORA:

“I swear I will bite you.”

NIURA:

“Think, Dora! We give him a perfect fake.  
He thinks he wins. He restores him and the city.  
And Aisha keeps the real power.”

The Djinn stares at her in awe.

Aisha holds the real Talisman close.

AISHA:

“Djinn...  
I wish for you to forge an exact copy of this.”

The Djinn stiffens.

DJINN:

“Aisha... if I do this... I cannot send you home.  
Your last way back disappears.”

Aisha doesn’t blink.

AISHA:

"This is my wish."

He gathers cosmic fire.

FLASH.

A perfect duplicate appears in his hand.

Aisha lifts the fake Talisman.

AISHA:

"Tomorrow, we face him. We give the Shadow King what he wants.  
He restores your people and you.

And I...

I finally learn the truth and... if my Talisman is that powerful, we will defeat him."

The Djinn bows low, deeply moved.

DJINN:

"Together."

They settle for the night, restless, beneath a sky of cold stars.  
Across the dunes, the jagged silhouette of the Shadow King's fortress  
waits like a nightmare holding its breath.

FADE OUT.

END of ACT 8.

## **ACT 9.**

### **The SHADOWS KING.**

EXT. DESERT - DAY

Dawn creeps over the desert in bruised lavender, warming into a pale gold  
as the wind howls through the hollows of the Ruined City.

Aisha stands at the cliff's edge, facing the horizon where a needle of black  
obsidian rises:



THE SHADOW KING'S PALACE — a fortress that scars the sky.

Her Talisman glows faintly beneath her fingers.  
Behind her, Dora paces, tail flicking sharply.

DORA (low growl):

“If we step one paw closer to that palace, I’m writing my will. And I’m leaving everything to the moths.”

Niura coils tightly around a broken stone, tasting the air.

NIURA:

“Nothing here can be trusted, Princess. Even the wind tastes of betrayal.”

The Djinn floats apart — ashamed, quiet, hands clasped like a frightened boy instead of a spirit.

Aisha turns to face them.

AISHA:

“If we wait, the Shadow King will destroy the hourglass... and then my kingdom... and then every other land.”

Dora sighs dramatically.

DORA:

“But do we REALLY have to go inside his palace? Can’t we just... find another way? Any other way at all?”

Aisha steps forward, meeting Dora’s eyes.

AISHA:

“If we hide, he wins. If we lie to him from afar, he wins.  
We face him — together.”

The Djinn floats closer, hesitant.

DJINN:

“There are old tunnels beneath my ruined city... I could hide you there.  
I could deliver the fake Talisman alone.

Buy us time—”

Aisha interrupts gently but firmly.

AISHA:

“No. If something happens to you while I’m hiding... I would never forgive myself. We go together.”

Dora groans, but nods with bitter acceptance.

DORA

“Fine. But I get to bite him first.”

Niura slides into Aisha’s pocket with a resigned exhale.

The Djinn bows his head, moved and terrified.

They cross the dunes as sunlight reveals the fortress fully —  
and it is worse than imagination.

EXT. SHADOWS KING PALACE. - AFTERNOON

Towers spiral like venomous fangs. Balconies jut like skeletal claws.  
A massive gate crawls with carved obsidian spiders. Sickly green smoke  
curls around the base of the towers.

The air grows darker... thicker... colder. As if the desert is holding its  
breath.

The Djinn clutches the Fake Talisman, breath shallow.  
He steps out alone toward the towering central gate.  
A massive door groans open, swallowing him into the green dark.

While the Djinn disappears behind the central gate, Aisha and Dora slip  
through a narrow, half-buried service passage on the palace’s left side.

INT. SHADOWS KING PALACE. - AFTERNOON

The corridor is dim, lined with bizarre artifacts: cracked obsidian masks,

floating shadow-figures trapped in glass, spider-shaped lanterns dripping green fire, scrolls pinned to walls with living black threads

Aisha moves silently, Dora stalking behind her.

They reach a rusted spiral stairway that leads up into darkness.  
Aisha climbs cautiously. Dora follows, muttering.

#### INT. SHADOW KING'S PRIVATE CHAMBER — CONTINUOUS

Aisha emerges into a vast, ornate private chamber with towering arabesque windows shaped like abstract spiderwebs.

The room is beautiful but eerie — deep blue curtains, golden embroidery, geometric carved pillars, a massive velvet armchair, shelves of strange books, glowing artifacts.

Aisha turns...  
and stops breathing.

On the wall:  
A fresco of Zahra, her mother — younger, radiant, wearing a white hijab adorned with pearls.

Aisha trembles.

AISHA (whisper):  
“No... that can't be...”

Dora steps beside her, eyes widening.

DORA (softly):  
“Zahra.”

Aisha spins toward her, stunned.

AISHA:  
“You— you knew her? Before?”

Dora nods, throat tight.

DORA:

"I knew her well... before the kingdom changed. That's her. He painted this."

Aisha touches the fresco with shaking fingers.

AISHA:

"But why is my mother in his chambers...?"

A distant BOOM echoes through the palace.  
The Djinn has entered the throne hall.

Dora stiffens.

AISHA:

"He will need our help. We need to be prepared"

DORA (whispering in horror):

"NO! NO WAY!.. Aisha — you cannot reveal yourself."

Aisha's eyes burn with determination.

AISHA:

"He's not a real Djinn. He's just an enchanted Prince — he doesn't have any magic left in him!"

But I have the real Talisman.

If he needs me... I won't let him face this alone."

DORA (rolling her eyes):

"Oh no. Don't tell me you're in love with the enchanted Prince..."

Aisha flushes — but there's no time.

Echoes rise from the throne hall below. Aisha comes closer to the wall trying to listen.

INT. SHADOW'S KING PALACE. THRONE ROOM. - AFTERNOON

The Throne Room is vast — torches of liquid green fire lick the walls, while black and dark-red marble floors veined with gold reflect the flames like pools of oil.

THE SHADOWS KING, SHARAK, emerges from behind an enormous table covered in dark magical artifacts: ancient scrolls, glowing liquids, rune-marked tomes, gems polished into pyramids, and pulsing obsidian spheres.

He wears long navy robes with armored accents; his turban is crowned with a color-shifting gem, moving from deep emerald to royal blue. His face is twisted into an elegant, permanent sneer.

Beside him sits his pet spider, NIBZU — a small violet-scaled creature with golden patterns and enormous googly amber eyes. It blinks stupidly, smiling with villainous devotion.

The Shadows King spreads his arms.

SHADOWS KING (mock-joyful):  
“Ahhhh... my faithful little Djinn returns!  
Did you bring me what I desire?”

The Djinn bows, voice trembling.

DJINN:  
“I have brought it.  
The Princess is lost to the Mirage City, trapped in luxury as you wished.  
Here is the Talisman.”

SHADOWS KING (with a huge grin, almost in disbelief):  
“Show me.”

The Djinn presents the fake Talisman.

The Shadows King snatches it, lifting it into the air like the treasure he has craved all his life. His mouth twists into an unhinged grin.

He laughs — long, echoing, violent.  
Dust shakes loose from the ceiling.

DJINN:

“I did my part. Now restore my form and my city, as we pacted!”

The Shadows King approaches slowly.

SHADOWS KING

“You want your humanity back?

A pact with a shadow is written in darkness, little Prince.

It cannot be read.”

The Djinn rises, fury trembling in his voice.

DJINN:

“You promised to restore my people!”

SHADOWS KING:

“Be grateful I do not turn you to dust this very instant.

I am in a good mood today, so I let you live.”

He leans in, mocking.

SHADOWS KING:

“On the bright side: you can live for centuries, not rot in the earth like her.”

He presses the locket to his chest.

SHADOWS KING:

“With this...

I will rule the world as it was meant to be.

With her by my side.”

Green fire swirls around him.

An orchestra of wicked strings and heavy brass swells through the chamber — the first notes of his dark theme.

SHADOWS KING SHARAK (singing):

VERSE 1

At last my wait is over, the stars align with fate,  
The skies all bow before me, the desert lies in wait.  
Half of my life in shadows, my love beneath the sand—  
Tonight the world will tremble beneath my guiding hand.

CHORUS:

For I will be the heartbeat  
Of every grain of sand,  
The rhythm of the ages,  
The ruler of this land.

For half my soul lay buried,  
for half my heart was stone—  
Tonight the world shall witness  
I shall not rule alone.

BRIDGE (Sharak + Nibzu call-and-response):

SHARAK:  
The stars will bend before me—

NIBZU:  
Bend, bend, bend!

SHARAK:  
The clouds will break in fear—

NIBZU:  
Break, break, break!

SHARAK:  
And she will walk beside me—  
A Queen reborn from sand

NIBZU (softly, creepily):  
She whispered in your madness...  
She always spoke your name...

SHARAK:  
And now the lock is open—  
Her heart begins to wake...

OUTRO (SHARAK in powerful voice):  
... Zahra!"

INT. SHADOWS KING PALACE - CONT.

Aisha's breath shatters.  
She rushes to the corridor and steps toward the main throne room  
entrance .

Dora bites her cloak, trying to stop her.

DORA (muffled)  
"AISHA— NO—!"

INT. THRONE ROOM — CONTINUOUS

AISHA  
"You said my mother's name."

The Shadow King SHARAK freezes.  
Then... he grins slowly.

SHARAK:  
"Well, well. The daughter arrives.  
You look exactly like her. Fascinating."

He circles her.

SHARAK:



“What a pity. You could have been my daughter. You could have ruled beside me... But destiny chose otherwise.”

AISHA:

“What do you want from us? Why did you attack our lands?”

His eyes ignite with madness.

SHARAK (voice cracking with hatred):

“Your father is a thief.

He stole Zahra from me.

She was promised to me — sold to him like a trophy.

She loved *me*, Aisha... until *you* ruined everything.”

Dora leaps beside Aisha.

DORA

“Don’t listen to the madman! He’s rewriting history!”

SNAP.

Golden spider-legs of energy erupt from the floor, forming a cage around Dora.

She roars, biting the bars, trapped.

Sharak snaps his fingers.

Nibzu scuttles forward with a golden cup, spitting glowing green venom inside.

SHARAK:

“Drink if you dare.

If real magic lives in you — you’ll see the truth about your mother.

If not... you’ll die.”

He laughs, cruel and delighted.

Aisha reaches for the cup.

NIURA (muffled from under her scarf):

“Aisha! No! It’s real venom!”

Aisha hesitates— but the need for truth overwhelms her.

She lifts the cup.

Niura lunges instinctively, touching her mouth to the rim — filtering the poison with her own body.

Aisha drinks.

Niura shudders, her green eyes rolling back. She falls limp onto Aisha’s shoulder, unconscious.

VISION — FLASHBACK

Zahra at night, rocking a crying baby Aisha. A tiny version of Nibzu spits venom into a cup with apple juice. He hides and watches giggling. Exhausted, Zahra reaches for the cup meant for the baby. She falls instantly. The baby continues crying.  
Darkness.

BACK TO SCENE

Aisha gasps violently, dropping the cup.

AISHA:

“The venom... it wasn’t for her. It was meant for ME.  
You killed her trying to kill me!”

Sharak laughs — broken, tragic, furious.

SHARAK (applauds mockingly):

“Bravo! You finally understand!

If you hadn’t been born — she’d still be alive. I would have saved her from your father. She would have loved me. But you— you ruined everything!”

Sharak turns to Nibzu.

SHARAK:

"And you! Look at her, she is still alive! You couldn't kill her twice, you useless thing!"

Nibzu covers its face with its legs in shame.

Aisha staggers back, horrified.

AISHA:

"You tried to kill me because she chose my father?!"

His face fractures — grief and rage colliding.

SHARAK:

"I wasn't always like this! We both used magic — for good! Until I lost her. I begged. I pleaded. Nothing worked."

He raises the fake Talisman high.

SHARAK (CONT'D):

"So I turned to dark magic.  
And it worked. Now I can finally bring her back."

He opens his arms, triumphant, insane. He convulses —  
EIGHT MASSIVE OBISIDIAN-LAVA SPIDER LEGS erupt from his back.

He towers above them.

SHARAK( roaring):

"LOOK WHAT SHE MADE ME BECOME!"

The Djinn rushes to Aisha's side.

SHARAK (laughs madly):

"Oh look. The traitor himself turning into a loving Prince? We need to fix that! I HATE happy endings!"

He conjures a seething PLASMA BALL.

SHARAK (shouts insane):

“You wanted wishes? I will grant you a final one!!”

He hurls it at DJINN.

The Djinn dodges, then leaps forward—

catching it mid-air with his bare hands, trembling under its force.

DJINN (straining):

“Aisha... RUN!”

Aisha refuses.

AISHA:

“I won’t leave you!”

DJINN

“This is your only chance. Save your kingdom... GO!”

With his free hand, he unleashes his final magic —

a WAVE OF LIGHT exploding from the window, forming a GOLDEN ARABESQUE Path in the air.

The last of his power drains. His glow flickers out.

The plasma breaks through his defense— SLAMS him into the wall.

He collapses, transforming back into the human Prince. He lies unmoving.

Sharak sends a surge of magic into Nibzu.

SHARAK:

“Destroy them!”

Nibzu grows into a GIANT TOWERING SPIDER, smashing walls and pillars.

The energy cage around Dora shatters.

She sprints to Aisha.

DORA:

“The Djinn did this for you! RUN!”

They dodge under Nibzu’s massive legs and sprint onto the collapsing Light Bridge.

The desert below is in chaos — storms tearing villages apart, lightning cracking the sky, the Hourglass’s magic destabilizing.

The light bridge collapses behind them as they run.

A shadow passes overhead —  
THE HAWK ALTAIR appears.

HAWK ALTAIR:  
“Aisha! Run faster!”

Aisha runs as fast as she can but the light path behind her collapses even faster.

HAWK flies over, in utter distress, shouting from above.

HAWK:  
“Aisha! JUMP! NOW!”

Aisha leaps into open air —

POOF.

She lands in a dune outside the palace, shaken but unharmed.

FADE OUT.  
END OF ACT 9.

## **ACT 10.**

### **THE ANCESTORS**

EXT. DUNES OUTSIDE THE PALACE — MOMENTS LATER

Aisha lies still for a moment, breathless — then pushes herself up on trembling arms.

The palace in the distance groans and collapses inward like a dying titan.

Altair lands beside her, wings beating dust into spirals.

ALTAIR (relieved, breathless):

“Aisha! I searched everywhere! Run to the Hourglass — now! I will bring help!”

He launches into the sky.

Dora drops beside Aisha, sand spraying.

She stumbles, shaking her fur, trying to hide her pain.

Aisha frantically clutches her scarf.

Niura slides out — dizzy, weak, barely conscious.

Aisha lifts her gently, pressing her cold scales to her cheek.

AISHA (voice cracking):

“You’re alive...You saved me.”

Niura groans softly.

Dora limps closer, looking at the tiny snake.

Her sarcasm, jealousy — gone.

DORA (quiet, sincere):

“To be honest... I owe you one, shoelace.

We’re officially friends now.”

Aisha barely moves.

She sits in the sand, staring at the empty horizon of endless dunes.

The guilt hits her like a blow.

She sinks to her knees.

AISHA (small, shaking):

“He killed my mother... and he killed him...  
He killed the Prince... And it’s all my fault. ”

Her voice cracks.

AISHA (CONT'D):

“If I hadn’t taken that sand... The Hourglass would still protect the Kingdom. Now he will destroy us.. ”

Dora steps in front of her, blocking the ruins, firm and protective.

DORA:

“Aisha. Listen to me.  
You didn’t destroy the balance on purpose.”

Aisha lifts her face — tear-streaked, guilty and fragile.

DORA (CONT'D):

“You couldn’t possibly know that taking sand would weaken it.”

Aisha touches her Talisman — glowing faintly, warm against her palm.

DORA (pointing at it):

“But now you do know. And you still have your mother’s Talisman.  
If anyone can restore the Hourglass... it’s you.”

Aisha breathes in — shaky, but steadier.

AISHA (quiet resolve):

“Then we need to reach it first. Before the Shadows King does.”

Dora nods sharply.

EXT. KINGDOM WALLS — LATER

They run through the dunes toward the towering Quazar al Zaman Walls.

The world around is breaking: sandstorms devour distant towns, The dunes rise and fall like a living sea

They see the Walls form the distance — and freeze.

The Majestic Chamber of the Hourglass stands torn open, like a colossal hole in the wall. Inside, the Hourglass glows faintly, flickering like a dying lantern.

The top bulb is nearly empty.

Aisha steps forward, eyes widening.

AISHA (soft, shaken):  
“It’s almost gone...”

Dora watches the sand drip — each grain falling too fast.

AISHA:  
“I have no more sand left... How do I restore the balance?”

A distant BOOM cracks the air.

And another.

They turn.

The Shadow King arrives.

Sharak rides atop the Giant NIBZU Spider, the beast lumbering like an excited warhorse.

Sharak’s eyes burn with deranged triumph; dark magic veins crackle across his skin.

Nibzu — despite being enormous — still has his goofy, crossed amber eyes and a silly smile.

SHARAK (manic):  
“There is no way to escape, Princess!”

He jerks the spider’s reins and leaps down.



Dora steps in front of Aisha, roaring with all the fury of a guardian.

Sharak barely glances at her.

He grabs Dora by the scruff and lifts her effortlessly.

SHARAK (laughing):  
“This kitten won’t stand in my way.”

He shakes her violently.

Dora gasps — but her eyes lock onto something:  
the Fake Talisman hanging from Sharak’s neck.

With a burst of courage she twists —  
CHOMP.  
She bites it free, kicks off his chest, and bolts.

Sharak loses his grip from the shock — and that’s enough.  
Dora hits the sand running, the fake talisman clenched in her teeth.

Sharak’s eyes bulge.

SHARAK:  
“My charm!”

He slaps the spider’s flank.

SHARAK:  
“You idiot! Don’t just stare — chase her!”

The giant spider lunges forward, clumsy and destructive.

Sharak sprints after them, screaming.

Aisha runs towards the massive break in the Kingdom walls and falls to her knees beneath the Hourglass.

She touches the cold glass.

AISHA (whisper):  
“Mother...  
Forgive me.  
Please... guide me.”

The Talisman grows warm, then hot, then luminous.

Niura, still weak, lifts her head.

NIURA (soft, awed)  
“Aisha... Are you remembering?  
Or is it... remembering you?”

Aisha’s eyes unfocus — as if something ancient is rising from within her.

She opens her mouth. What leaves her is not a lullaby. It sounds more like an anthem. And the sands hear her.

A swirling cylindrical wall of golden sand rises around her.

Dora skids to a halt outside, throws the fake talisman as far as she can, then sprints back and dives inside just before the wall seals shut.

Inside, every storm dies..

Aisha lifts her gaze — and the world dissolves.

INT. TEMPLE OF LIGHT — SPIRIT REALM

A breathtaking sacred hall materializes around Aisha.

Quartz mosaics shimmer beneath her feet, shifting like living patterns.  
Light motes float through the air like drifting souls.  
Endless walls of arabesque-laced windows cast soft, intricate patterns across the glimmering floor.

It is quiet and peaceful.  
A faint ethereal melody hums — as if light itself is singing.

At the far end stands a woman in flowing white —

a long dress adorned with pearls,  
a silky headscarf catching and bending the light like water.

Aisha freezes. Tears spill instantly down her cheeks.

She takes a few slow steps toward the figure... then stops, unable to move closer.

AISHA (whispering):  
“Mom...?”

The figure turns, her eyes soft and radiant.

ZAHRA:  
“Aisha.”

Aisha breaks.  
She runs into her mother’s arms, collapsing into a desperate, longing hug.

AISHA (sobbing):  
“I’m sorry... I didn’t know...  
I missed you so much.”

Zahra strokes her hair with infinite gentleness.

ZAHRA (soft):  
“My Aisha...  
my brave girl...  
It’s been so long.”

Aisha pulls back, trembling.

AISHA:  
“Mom... I ruined everything.  
The kingdom... the Hourglass...  
Father is in danger...  
I don’t know what to do.”

Zahra cups her face in both hands, lifting it gently.

ZAHRA (tender):

“Your memories are coming back, Aisha. And I, and all our Ancestors, are connected through those memories. And now... it’s time for us to wake up.”

Zahra smiles and leans forward, placing her forehead against Aisha’s. Aisha closes her eyes. The hum deepens around her.

The temple dissolves.

EXT. KINGDOM WALLS — CONT.

Aisha stands within the golden protective sands swirling around her, still singing.

From the dunes surrounding the Kingdom Walls, the sand erupts upward like dancers emerging from water.

Six Giant SAND GUARDIANS form. Their bodies are made of kinetic sand, golden arabesque patterns flowing like liquid light, faces hidden beneath hoods of swirling grains.

Aisha’s voice guides them. They dance around her in a circle, lift hands the sand streams down like cascade of shimmering light. as they glide on the sand a giant glowing mandala like protective patterns form on the sand around Aisha, the patterns shift and glow as if sands were listening to her song.

EXT. SAND DUNES BENEATH THE KINGDOM WALLS - CONT.

Sharak scrambles to pick up the fake Talisman Dora has thrown. He shakes it — nothing. He whispers to it — nothing. He screams at it - and still nothing.

SHARAK (furious, unraveling):

“Why are you not working?!”

You stupid, useless charm!

OBEY ME! I command you!”

Suddenly, just inches from his feet, the sand bursts upward, swirling in tight spirals.

A small tornado forms — then another — each rising higher, wider, roaring with ancient force.

From within the spirals, giant shapes emerge, sculpted from sand and light.

Sharak screams.

He throws the fake talisman away and tries to run — but the sand shifts beneath him.

He struggles forward in slow motion, sinking, dragging his legs as if the dunes were pulling him down.

He falls hard.

He rolls onto his back, breathless, staring up in terror.

The Giant NIBZU Spider pauses watching its master flee.

It tilts its head — with a big silly smile, almost amused.

The Sand Giants form a circle around NIBZU. He snaps at them, but they move with fluid grace — dodging like dancers made of wind.

They flick sparks of golden sand toward NIBZU.

Where the sparks land, “liquid warp gold” flows across its legs like reverse lava, crawling upward in shimmering streams.

The NIBZU freezes in place, its entire body turning into a massive, majestic Golden Statue, carved with delicate arabesque patterns that catch the light like jewelry.

Clouds part overhead.

Sunlight breaks through in radiant columns.

The Shadow King tries to get onto his feet when he sees Aisha coming toward him.

He staggers, fists glowing with fresh plasma, ready to strike again.

Aisha doesn't stop walking.  
She steps toward him — tiny, trembling, but unyielding.

Alsha (steady, glowing talisman lighting her chest):  
“I'm not afraid of you.  
Mother told me you were never the darkness I should fear.”

Sharak snarls — confused, furious — his fists blazing brighter.  
But Aisha does not step back.

Her Talisman flares.  
The ground hums.

Sharak flinches — his plasma fades like dying embers.

A soft whirl rises behind Aisha.  
He sees it first.

Aisha turns.

And—

## THE SPIRIT OF ZAHRA APPEARS

A towering figure of white-sand and diamond dust blossoms out of the breeze, majestic, serene, shimmering with light.

She rises higher — taller than the dunes,  
taller than the Hourglass, a living memory made of wind and stardust.

Aisha gasps, tears spilling — she never expected this.

The Spirit leans over Aisha, one sand-hand hovering around her like a protective embrace.  
Aisha looks miniature beside her towering form.

Sharak stares, breath hollow.

SHARAK (whisper, breaking):  
“...Zahra...?”

The Spirit does not speak but the rims of her flowing sand robes begin to glow with golden light.

Aisha feels the meaning through her, as if her mother's thoughts pass directly into her voice.

She steps forward without fear.

AISHA (voice calm, carrying her mother's strength):

"You always said you became a shadow because of her.  
But she is here now... standing in the light.  
So what do you choose?  
A kingdom of fear and black magic?  
Or your true form?"

Sharak's rage collapses in an instant.  
He suddenly looks like an old, tired man.

SHARAK (raising voice through the wind):  
"All I did... was for you, Zahra."

He looks around — the ruins, the Hourglass, the broken Walls

SHARAK:  
"I would have destroyed kingdoms to bring your back."

His voice trembles.

SHARAK (CONT'D):  
"But you're standing here... and your light leaves no shadow in me."

He lifts his hand toward the Spirit, barely able to keep it steady.

SHARAK (pleading):  
"I don't belong to this world if there is no you. Take me with you."

The Spirit extends her hand — sand swirling like a gentle storm.

Their fingers touch.

Sharak exhales, the last weight leaving his chest.

They dissolve into golden sand together, rising like shimmering dust carried by the wind toward the Hourglass.

The Hourglass fills, glowing warm and bright.  
The flow restarts. Light shoots through the cracks of the Kingdom Walls.  
Clouds part. The golden spider statue glimmers.

Dora and Niura stare, baffled.

DORA:  
“Is he... just gone like that?”

AISHA (a quite smile):  
“He mended what he broke. And he helped restore the balance.  
Wherever he is now...I hope he won’t return.”

Dora presses her forehead to Aisha’s cheek.  
Niura curls around Aisha’s arm.

Together they watch the Hourglass glow — sand flowing steady again as sunbeams pierce through the fractured ceiling of the Hourglass Chamber.

Balance is restored.

FADE OUT.  
END OF ACT 10.

ACT 11. ON THE WINGS OF RISING SAND.

EXT. WALLS OF THE KINGDOM - HOURGLASS. AFTERNOON

Aisha comes close to the Hourglass.  
She sits beneath it, pressing her palm to the glass as if still connected to her mother — listening through the hum of sand.



Dora limps over and settles beside her.

Aisha reaches out, scratching behind her ears. Dora leans her heavy head into Aisha's cheek, purring like a warm engine.

DORA (sighing, content):

"You know... being a hero is exhausting. My paws are killing me. Think we have to walk back?"

AISHA (smiling):

"To be honest... I don't think we'll need it. Look up."

A shriek pierces the blue sky.

The Hawk ALTAIR circles overhead, diving in happy loops.

Over the dunes, a procession appears — not a military march, but a rescue party. Dozens of white camels draped in silk and gold descend the slope. At their center, a royal palanquin gleams.

The caravan stops. The Sultan does not wait for ceremony.

He jumps off the camel and runs — his royal turban crooked, his arms open.

SULTAN:

"Aisha!"

Aisha rises.

AISHA:

"Father?"

He sweeps her into a trembling embrace.

SULTAN:

"Aisha... my brave girl. Are you harmed? Did the shadows reach you?"

Aisha pulls back.

AISHA:

"I'm fine, Dad. I restored the balance."

He looks toward the Hourglass, then back at her — humbled.

SULTAN:

"The Hawk told me everything. You did what I could not. I hid you because I feared losing you like I lost your mother."

He cups her face.

SULTAN:

"But you were braver than me. You faced what I ran from."

AISHA:

"We didn't do it alone. Mom... she helped me."

Tears fill his eyes, but he smiles — proud, open, transformed.

SULTAN:

"My little Aisha... From today, you will rule by my side until you are ready to reign."

EXT. THE KINGDOM of QUAZAR AL ZAMAN. AFTERNOON.

The journey back is a celebration.

Drums, zurna flutes, saffron powder showering the sky.

Aisha sits atop the lead camel; Dora walks beside her wearing a wreath of flowers, Niura proudly curls on her shoulder.

They enter the Palace Courtyard. The Sultan helps Aisha down.

SULTAN:

"Go. Prepare yourself. Tonight we feast. And... I have a big surprise for you."

INT. PALACE BALLROOM. NIGHT.

Aisha disappears in her chambers. When she emerges, she is transformed. The travel-worn clothes are gone. She wears a pale pink-lavender kaftan with golden embroidery, constellations dancing along the silk flowing fabric. A shimmering scarf flows behind her like dawnlight.

Dora and Niura wait outside the door like two mischievous guardians.

Dora lifts an eyebrow, impressed.

DORA (grinning):

“Well... someone’s ready to cause at least three royal heart attacks.”

Niura coils upward, eyes sparkling.

NIURA:

“A surprise waits downstairs.

A big one. Try not to faint, little queen.”

Aisha frowns, amusement tugging at her mouth.

AISHA:

“What did you two do?”

DORA:

“Us? Nothing.

Destiny, however... has excellent timing.”

They exchange a smug look.

Aisha’s pulse picks up.

She descends the GRAND STAIRCASE.

The ballroom quiets.

Lanterns flicker.

The crowd parts — gently, respectfully — revealing a young man standing with his back to her.

He wears an ivory kaftan with golden rims, a mantle held by a moonstone clasp flanked by two tiny emeralds.

The inner fabric glows softly, like warm morning light breathing beneath the cloth.

His hands tremble slightly at his sides. He is trying — and failing — to stay calm.

Aisha freezes halfway down the steps.

Her voice barely exists.

AISHA (whisper):  
“...No...”

The young man turns.

His smile breaks like sunrise.

PRINCE:  
“Aisha.”

Aisha's hand flies to her mouth.  
Her knees nearly give out.

Dora nudges Niura.

DORA (whispering, smug):  
“There she goes.”

Aisha reaches the bottom step.

AISHA (shaking):  
“I saw you fall... I thought— I thought—”

He gently takes her hands.

PRINCE (soft, breathless):  
“I know. When the spell shattered...  
I woke on the floor of the Shadow's King Palace.  
My Kingdom was restored.  
But the first thing I did was to run here.  
I swear, Aisha, I've never moved faster in my life.”

Aisha laughs through tears — half sob, half joy.

The Sultan steps beside them, smiling with warmth Aisha has never seen on his face.

SULTAN (uniting their hands):  
“Maybe one day you will rule together...”

Dora leans against a column.

DORA:  
“I’m just saying... I called this.”

Niura slaps her with her tail.

PRINCE (gentle):  
“You saved two kingdoms.  
And... you saved me.”

AISHA (quiet, glowing):  
“We saved each other.”

Their foreheads nearly touch.

The orchestra begins.

He offers his hand.

PRINCE:  
“May I?”

Aisha smiles.

AISHA:  
“Yes.”

They step into the center of the ballroom.  
They start to sing.

BOTH (CHORUS):

On the wings of rising sand,

Love awakens shining bright.  
Every heartbeat shapes the land,  
every spirit lights a star  
in the quiet of the night.

---

AISHA (singing):

I feel the echoes of the past  
guiding me with every stride.  
Voices of the ones before me  
walking softly by my side.

---

PRINCE (singing):

I followed echoes through the night,  
seeking truth beyond my sight.  
If you listen with your heart,  
every shadow turns to light.

---

BOTH (REPRISE):

On the wings of rising sand,  
Love awakens shining bright.  
Every heartbeat shapes the land,  
every spirit lights a star  
in the quiet of the night.

INT. GRAND BALLROOM — NIGHT

The music swells into its final luminous crescendo.  
The camera glides past lanterns, shimmering fabrics, dancers spinning like  
trails of starlight—

—and then gently pans toward the side of the ballroom.

Dora lounges like royalty on a massive velvet cushion embroidered with golden thread.

A delicate Gold Crown sits slightly crooked on her head — she wears it with the confidence of someone born to be admired.

Next to her, Niura coils elegantly on a silk pillow of deep emerald-green, a tiny, perfectly crafted snake-sized crown glinting on her head.

Dora smirks.

DORA

“Finally. The respect we deserve.”

Niura flicks her tail dramatically.

NIURA

“Quiet, feline. I’m trying to sparkle.”

They bump heads affectionately — two unlikely friends who crossed a world together.

The orchestra rises.

The camera sweeps back to the center of the ballroom.

Aisha and the Prince spin together in a gentle turn beneath a dome of lanterns and stars.

A faint, wondrous magic lingers in the air.

As Aisha twirls, her Talisman glows softly, and tiny motes of golden light drift from it like fireflies woven with memories.

The motes spiral upward — swirling into geometric arabesque patterns, moving like calligraphy written by the wind.

They float past the balcony, rising toward the night sky above the palace.

The golden motes gather among the real stars.  
They settle, align, shimmer—

—and form graceful Arabic calligraphy across the sky.

The calligraphy glows brighter, then slowly transforms into English:

AISHA

The letters pulse with light.

The stars behind them blink softly.

FADE TO BLACK.

**THE END**